



**Help Information Technology
Consultancy - Sole Proprietorship
LLC**

*Business Avenue Tower
2nd Floor, Office: 203-B,
Al-Salam Street,
PO Box 37195
Abu Dhabi,
United Arab Emirates*

*Phone +971 2 644 3398
Fax +971 2 639 1155*

*www.helpag.com
info@helpag.com*

HCT

HELP AG TECHNICAL PROPOSAL

SECURE ACCESS SERVICE EDGE (SASE)

Reference: NE-26-0129

Version: 1.1

Issue Date: 02/09/2026

As Bt



Document Control

AUTHOR	REVIEWER	BDM
Mohammad Saleem	Sini Thulasidas	Mahmoud Said

Revision History

VERSION	DATE ISSUED	STATUS	CHANGE	CHANGED BY
1.0	02/09/2026	Initial	Initial release	Saleem
1.1	02/09/2026	Review	Minor Changes	Sini

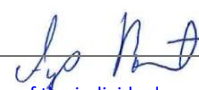
Intellectual Property Rights

This document contains valuable trade secrets and confidential information of Help AG and its suppliers and partners. Any content shall not be disclosed to any person, organization or entity unless such disclosure is subject to the products provisions of a written non-disclosure agreement and proprietary rights agreement or intellectual property license agreement approved by Help AG. The distribution of this document does not grant any license or rights in whole or in part to the content, the product(s), technology or intellectual property described herein

Table of Contents

1	Executive Summary	1
	A. Products & Technology	1
	B. Professional Services	1
	C. Post-Implementation Support & Managed Services	2
1.1	Help AG's Added Value	2
1.2	Specific Expertise for this Project	3
2	Scope of Work	5
	A. Products & Technology	5
	B. Professional Services	5
	C. Post-Implementation Support & Managed Services	6
2.1	Implementation Scope of Work	6
	2.1.1 Indicative Implementation Project Plan	1
	2.1.2 Sample CVs	1
	2.1.3 Dependencies	1
	2.1.4 Assumptions to Deliver the Scope of Work	1
	2.1.5 Out of Scope	3
2.2	Post Implementation Support Services	4
	2.2.1 Resident Engineer Responsibilities	4
	2.2.2 Help AG Managed Security Controls Services	6
3	Compliance Table	9
3.1	Help AG Response to Evaluation Criteria	10
4	Help AG Review Comments to the RFP	11
5	Project Management Matrix	13
6	Bill of Materials	14
7	Appendix A: Zscaler SASE Solution	16
7.1	Zscaler Profile	16
7.2	Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA)	18
	7.2.1 Understanding the ZIA Cloud Architecture	19
	7.2.2 Traffic Forwarding	20
	7.2.3 Zscaler Zero Trust Firewall	22
	7.2.4 Zscaler Zero Trust Sandboxing	27
	7.2.5 Zscaler Zero Trust Browser (ZTBrowser)	31
	7.2.6 Zscaler AI Guard for Users	34
7.3	Zscaler Private Access (ZPA)	36
	7.3.1 Key Capabilities	37

7.3.2	Getting Started with ZPA	37
7.3.3	ZPA Cloud Architecture	38
7.3.4	Traffic Forwarding	39
7.3.5	Understanding Communication Between Components and Subsystems	41
7.3.6	Transitioning to a Zero Trust ZPA Deployment	42
7.3.7	AI-Powered Segmentation	43
7.3.8	Zscaler VPN (For Legacy Apps)	45
7.4	Zscaler Digital Experience Monitoring (ZDX)	46
7.4.1	Key Capabilities	47
7.4.2	Understanding ZDX Probes	48
7.4.3	Applications Monitoring	50
7.4.4	ZDX, ZPA and Private Applications	52
7.4.5	Device Scoring and Device Events	53
8	Appendix B: Project Management	55
8.1	Project Management Methodology	55
8.1.1	Purpose	55
8.1.2	How Projects are Managed and Maintained	55
8.1.3	Help AG's Project Management Methodology	55
8.1.4	Applied Change Management Procedures	58
8.1.5	Applied Risk Management Procedures	59
8.1.6	Quality Assurance Procedures	60
9	Appendix C: About Help AG	61
9.1	Our Mission	61
9.2	Help AG – Key Facts	61
9.3	Our Capabilities and Services Portfolio	61
9.4	Customer Satisfaction	61
9.5	Vendor Certificate	62
9.6	Major Vendor Partnership Levels	63
9.7	Help AG Project Specific Customer References	64
9.8	General Customer Reference	65




1 Executive Summary

Help AG would like to thank HCT for the opportunity to submit this technical proposal. The proposed solution will establish a secure, scalable and centrally managed **Zscaler Zero Trust SASE** environment for the HCT, supporting approximately **29,000+ users and up to 45,000 concurrent devices** across campuses, data centers, remote users and cloud-connected services. The engagement will modernize the existing on-premises Zscaler web-proxy environment into a cloud-delivered security architecture, providing consistent protection for managed endpoints, BYOD users, Internet/SaaS access and, optionally, private applications.

A. Products & Technology

The solution will leverage **Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA)** as the core cloud-delivered Internet and SaaS security platform, providing Secure Web Gateway, SSL/TLS inspection, Cloud Firewall, IPS, DNS Security, advanced threat protection, URL/application controls and centralized security policy enforcement. **Zscaler Client Connector** will provide secure, policy-driven access for managed endpoints, while network-based forwarding will secure campus and BYOD traffic. The solution will also incorporate **Zscaler Digital Experience (ZDX)** for end-user and application experience visibility and, subject to the selected licensing, SaaS/CASB, Data Security, GenAI security and Browser Isolation/Zero Trust Browser capabilities. **Zscaler Private Access (ZPA)** may be provided as an optional capability for approximately 200 users requiring Zero Trust access to approved private applications.

PRODUCT NAME	SKU	QUANTITY
ZIA Business Edition	ZIA-BIZ-EDITION	2719
Extended Log Store	ZSC-LOG-EXTSUBS	2719
ZDX Advanced Plus	ZDX-ADV-PLUS	2719
Zscaler Inline Cyber Threat Protection- Sandbox Advanced	ZS-CTP-SANDBOX	2719
Zscaler Inline Cyber Threat Protection- Firewall Advanced	ZS-CTP-FIREWALL	2719
Secure AI Access	ZS-AI-ACCESS-PRE	2719
Zero Trust Browser Advanced	ZT-BROWSER-ADV	29022
Zscaler Private Access Platform	ZS-ZPA-PLATFORM	200
ZPA for Legacy Apps (VOIP, S2C, etc.)	ZS-ZPA-VPN	200
Zscaler Private Access: Segmentation	ZS-ZPA-SEGM	200
Zscaler Test Environment	ZS-TEST-ENV	1
Zscaler Support Plus	ZCES-SUP-PLUS	1

B. Professional Services

Help AG project management, governance and professional services engagement will cover the complete **assessment, design, implementation, integration, migration, testing and handover** lifecycle. Activities will include assessment of the existing Zscaler web-proxy environment; policy rationalization and migration; HLD/LLD development; ZIA tenant configuration; SSL inspection; Client Connector deployment; campus and BYOD traffic forwarding; Cloud Firewall, DNS and threat-policy configuration; ZDX enablement; Migration will follow controlled pilot and production waves with defined rollback procedures, performance baselining, UAT and stabilization before retirement of the legacy on-premises proxy environment. Comprehensive as-built

documentation, operational runbooks and knowledge transfer will be provided at project completion. All services will be delivered in a **hybrid manner (onsite & remote)**.

C. Post-Implementation Support & Managed Services

Following implementation, Help AG will provide customer-specific **Zscaler tenant managed services**, covering daily service-health monitoring, tenant and security-policy administration, Client Connector support, SSL/TLS inspection management, campus/BYOD connectivity troubleshooting, integration monitoring, incident/problem/change management, policy optimization, ZDX performance monitoring, OEM escalation management, operational reporting and continual service improvement.

A dedicated **Help AG Resident Engineer will be available onsite on an 8x5 basis during Customer business days**, providing day-to-day operational support, troubleshooting, approved configuration changes, policy administration, integration support, OEM case coordination, documentation maintenance and continuous knowledge transfer to Customer teams. Critical incidents outside the resident engineer's working hours will be handled through Help AG 24X7 **Remote** Managed Security Controls services and Zscaler.

1.1 Help AG's Added Value

Help AG is the biggest cybersecurity service provider in the region, with an experience that spans over 25 years. As of 17 February 2020, Etisalat Group is the sole Help AG shareholder and Help AG is the cybersecurity arm of **e& enterprise**.

Powered by the 12th largest Telco in the world, Help AG is enviably positioned as the strongest force in the field of digital security- in terms of the number of qualified experts, digital domain expertise and financial flexibility. Help AG provides leading enterprise businesses across the Middle East with strategic consultancy combined with tailored information security solutions and services that address their diverse requirements, enabling them to evolve securely with a competitive edge.

Help AG has successfully implemented protection for some of the region's largest and most prestigious public and private organizations who have relied on us to protect their most critical online portals, applications, networks, and back-end data centres. We do all this while providing 24/7 local support services and same day hardware replacement for all products. By constantly monitoring security trends and their impact on Middle East businesses, we enhance and upgrade our portfolio.

Help AG has always taken the role of a market evangelist when it comes to pioneering new technologies, be it secure cloud enablement, OT security, or the utilization of machine learning for enhanced agility and efficiency in dealing with cyber threats, as well as advanced cybersecurity services like world class penetration testing services, Incident Response, Breach Investigation and Forensics, Cyber Insurance, Governance, Risk and Compliance, 24X7 Managed Detection and Response, and Managed Threat Intelligence among others..



HOLISTIC SECURITY

- From Analysis to Consulting, Support, Integration & Operations
- Cloud-ready SDX Security
- IT-IoT-OT
- Predictive, Proactive & Responsive
- Threat Intel Driven



PURPOSE-BUILT CYBERSECURITY ECOSYSTEM

- In country ISO 27001 SOC
- Local Security Clouds
- Partners, Tools & Platforms



DIGITAL DOMAIN EXPERTISE

- Largest team of cybersecurity experts
- 24x7 availability with flexible deployment models
- Cross-industry expertise



FINANCIAL FLEXIBILITY

- Flexible OPEX models
- Pay as you Grow
- Highest tier vendor partnerships



1.2 Specific Expertise for this Project

Help AG is well known for our focus on delivering innovative and robust solutions to complex information and cybersecurity issues.

Our relationship with the leading technology companies within the security industry over the last 25 years, means that we today deliver a full portfolio of services spanning the full lifecycle of the technology selected.

We are proud to be recognized as through leaders by our industry and peers.

To highlight a few of the awards we have received recently (2023 – 2024):

- “Best Partner Award” by Department of Digital Ajman
- “Best Partner Award” by TDRA
- “Strategic Partner Award” by Ajman Municipality
- Intersec Awards – “Women Trailblazers in Cybersecurity
- CyberKnight – “Highest Cybersecurity Market Leadership”
- Gulf IT Network Distribution – “Kingpin of Technology Excellence”
- Starlink – “Regional Cybersecurity Advisor”
- CXO Insight – “Cloud Security Services Provider of the Year 2023”
- CXO Insight – ICT Saudi – “Best Managed Cyber Defense”
- Frost & Sullivan – “Middle East Digital Forensics Industry”
- Frost & Sullivan – “Company of the Year in the Middle Eastern Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS)”
- GEC Awards 2023 – “Top Service Provider – Managed Cyber Defense”
- GEC Media Group – “Best Defensive Security”
- IDC MarketScape – “Leader in the 2023 GCC Managed Security Services Vendor Assessment”
- ITP.net – “Security Leadership Awards”
- Future Security by tahawultech.com – “Best Managed Security Services Provider of the Year”
- Amiviz Partner – “Excellence Award”
- Fortinet – “Growth Partner of the Year – International Emerging
- Fortinet – “UAE Partner of the Year”
- Microsoft – “Leader in Microsoft Security”
- Keysight Partner Awards – “EMEA Strategic Partner of the Year 2023”
- Keysight Partner – “Partner of the Year Excellence Award”
- Proofpoint – “Partner of the Year 2023 – UAE + Gulf”
- Redington Reimagine – “Cybersecurity Partner of the Year”

Signature



- Trend Micro – “Strategic Partner of the Year”
- Vectra AI – “Partner of the Year 2023 – METNA”
- Zscaler – “EMEA Growth Partner of the Year”

We have carefully considered HCT request and believe that we are unique in being able to provide professional services that will meet and exceed your expectations.



2 Scope of Work

Help AG takes a consultative approach when working on projects, meaning that we work closely with the customer in the project planning, execution and handover phase in identifying requirements, implementation details and tuning of the solution, hereby delivering a value add by delivering an optimized time to service through a full turn-key implementation of the proposed technologies and overall solution design.

The proposed solution will establish a secure, scalable and centrally managed **Zscaler Zero Trust SASE** environment for the HCT, supporting approximately **29,000+ users and up to 45,000 concurrent devices** across campuses, data centres, remote users and cloud-connected services. The engagement will modernize the existing on-premises Zscaler web-proxy environment into a cloud-delivered security architecture, providing consistent protection for managed endpoints, BYOD users, Internet/SaaS access and, optionally, private applications.

A. Products & Technology

The solution will leverage **Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA)** as the core cloud-delivered Internet and SaaS security platform, providing Secure Web Gateway, SSL/TLS inspection, Cloud Firewall, IPS, DNS Security, advanced threat protection, URL/application controls and centralized security policy enforcement. **Zscaler Client Connector** will provide secure, policy-driven access for managed endpoints, while network-based forwarding will secure campus and BYOD traffic. The solution will also incorporate **Zscaler Digital Experience (ZDX)** for end-user and application experience visibility and, subject to the selected licensing, SaaS/CASB, Data Security, GenAI security and Browser Isolation/Zero Trust Browser capabilities. **Zscaler Private Access (ZPA)** may be provided as an optional capability for approximately 200 users requiring Zero Trust access to approved private applications.

PRODUCT NAME	SKU	QUANTITY
ZIA Business Edition	ZIA-BIZ-EDITION	2719
Extended Log Store	ZSC-LOG-EXTSUBS	2719
ZDX Advanced Plus	ZDX-ADV-PLUS	2719
Zscaler Inline Cyber Threat Protection- Sandbox Advanced	ZS-CTP-SANDBOX	2719
Zscaler Inline Cyber Threat Protection- Firewall Advanced	ZS-CTP-FIREWALL	2719
Secure AI Access	ZS-AI-ACCESS-PRE	2719
Zero Trust Browser Advanced	ZT-BROWSER-ADV	29022
Zscaler Private Access Platform	ZS-ZPA-PLATFORM	200
ZPA for Legacy Apps (VOIP, S2C, etc.)	ZS-ZPA-VPN	200
Zscaler Private Access: Segmentation	ZS-ZPA-SEGM	200
Zscaler Test Environment	ZS-TEST-ENV	1
Zscaler Support Plus	ZCES-SUP-PLUS	1

B. Professional Services

Help AG project management, governance and professional services engagement will cover the complete **assessment, design, implementation, integration, migration, testing and handover** lifecycle. Activities will include assessment of the existing Zscaler web-proxy environment; policy rationalization and migration.

HLD/LLD development; ZIA tenant configuration; SSL inspection; Client Connector deployment; campus and BYOD traffic forwarding; Cloud Firewall, DNS and threat-policy configuration; ZDX enablement; Migration will follow controlled pilot and production waves with defined rollback procedures, performance baselining, UAT and stabilization before retirement of the legacy on-premises proxy environment. Comprehensive as-built documentation, operational runbooks and knowledge transfer will be provided at project completion. All services will be delivered in a **hybrid manner (onsite & remote)**.

C. Post-Implementation Support & Managed Services

Following implementation, Help AG will provide customer-specific Zscaler tenant managed services, covering daily service-health monitoring, tenant and security-policy administration, Client Connector support, SSL/TLS inspection management, campus/BYOD connectivity troubleshooting, integration monitoring, incident/problem/change management, policy optimization, ZDX performance monitoring, OEM escalation management, operational reporting and continual service improvement.

A dedicated Help AG Resident Engineer will be available onsite on an 8x5 basis during Customer business days, providing day-to-day operational support, troubleshooting, approved configuration changes, policy administration, integration support, OEM case coordination, documentation maintenance and continuous knowledge transfer to Customer teams. Critical incidents outside the resident engineer's working hours will be handled through Help AG 24X7 **Remote** Managed Security Controls services and Zscaler.

2.1 Implementation Scope of Work

The engagement includes modernization of the existing on-premises Zscaler web-proxy environment to the target Zscaler cloud platform. Implementation services shall cover ZIA, Client Connector, Cloud Firewall, SSL inspection, DNS Security, threat protection, SaaS/GenAI security, ZDX, enterprise integrations, migration, testing and handover.

Technical workshop and Assessment

- Conduct project kick-off and detailed technical workshops.
- Assess the existing Zscaler web-proxy architecture, traffic flows and policy configurations to understand the current setup .
- Understand campus, Primary DC, DR, Internet breakout and WAN/NGFW connectivity to decide on traffic forwarding mechanism to Zscaler cloud.
- Assess managed users, BYOD, guest, administrative and remote-user requirements.
- Establish migration, testing, performance baseline, rollback and acceptance requirements.

Design Document

- Provide design and implementation document in English.

Existing Policy Assessment & Migration up to policies overall

- Review all existing policies on the on-premises ZScaler (hardware infrastructure) and migrate all relevant policies to the SASE cloud

Secure Web Gateway / URL Filtering up to 30 URL Filtering policies

The implementation partner shall configure:



- URL filtering policies for users, groups and locations.
- Standard and customer-defined URL categories.
- Allow, block, caution and other approved actions.
- Safe Search and applicable search-engine controls.
- File-type control up to 10 Policies
- Required web-access exceptions.

Cloud App policies

- Cloud App Control / Shadow IT visibility: application discovery and risk-tiered reporting. Configure Risk profiles and create risk-based policies on all cloud application categories.
- Based on the requirements configure up to 20 Cloud App control CASB policies.

SSL/TLS Inspection Up to **20 SSL Inspection policies/rules**, including agreed inspection and bypass policy rules.

- Configure SSL/TLS inspection using the Customer Sub-CA for managed devices.
- Enable inspection for supported TLS traffic.
- Configure privacy/regulatory bypass categories.
- Configure certificate-pinned and technically incompatible application exceptions.
- Validate SSL inspection against representative critical applications.
- Troubleshoot Zscaler-side SSL policy and certificate issues.

Customer PKI redesign, certificate authority deployment and remediation of certificate-pinned applications are excluded.

Cloud Firewall – implement up to **30 Cloud Firewall policies/rules**

- User/group-based firewall policies.
- IP/subnet and FQDN-based rules.
- Application-aware Layer 7 policies.
- Internet service/protocol controls.
- Required approved firewall exceptions.

Threat Prevention

- Enable applicable Zscaler threat-protection services.
- Configure malware and phishing protection.
- Enable botnet/C2 and malicious-destination controls.
- Configure file and threat inspection settings.



DNS Security – configure up to 10 policies

- DNS security policies
- Malicious/phishing domain protection.
- DGA and DNS tunnelling controls.
- Newly registered/observed domain controls where supported.
- DNS category-based restrictions.
- User/group/location-based DNS controls up to 10
- Required DNS security exceptions.

Data Security / DLP

Integrate with Microsoft purview for data classification tags and configure up to 10 DLP policies.

GenAI Security

The implementation partner shall configure:

- Discover and classify Generative-AI application usage across the user base.
- Configure granular access controls (allow / isolate / block) for sanctioned and unsanctioned AI tools.
- Configure DLP controls for sensitive data entered into AI prompts and file uploads.

Browser Isolation / Zero Trust Browser

- Configure browser isolation policies for high-risk categories.
- Configure session controls: copy/paste, upload/download, watermarking, and clipboard restrictions as required.

Deployment Zscaler Client Connector for Up to 1500 users

The implementation partner shall:

- Configure application and forwarding profiles.
- Configure trusted-network detection and traffic steering.
- Configure posture, and approved bypass requirements.
- Prepare ZCC deployment packages for bulk installation using HCT MDM tool.
- Support pilot and phased production rollout.

Campus Traffic Forwarding for BYOD Devices

The implementation partner shall:

- Configure Zscaler-side campus/location definitions up to 20 locations.
- Configure agreed GRE/IPsec forwarding up to 20 sites with redundancy based on requirements
- Configure Location based URL and cloud app control policies,



Identity Integration

- Configure ZIdentity federation with the customer's identity provider (Azure AD, ADFS, or equivalent) via SAML 2.0 / SCIM.
- Provision user and group objects via SCIM for automated user lifecycle management.

External Integration Scope

INTEGRATION REQUIREMENTS	IN SCOPE / OUT OF SCOPE
3.9.1 Identity Provider (IdP) + MFA: SAML 2.0, OIDC, SCIM for user/group provisioning. Must support Azure AD/Entra ID, HCT inhouse F5 SAML, and on-premises AD via federation. MFA enforcement at the SASE layer for every access request. Support for Edu Roam Federation.	HCT inhouse F5 SAML MFA enforcement at the SASE layer for every access request. Support for Edu Roam Federation is out of scope
3.9.2 Network Access Control (NAC): Integration via RADIUS CoA, REST API, or syslog to receive device posture and classification signals from the NAC. The SASE platform should accept NAC posture tags to differentiate policy for compliant vs. non-compliant devices.	Out of implementation scope
3.9.3 Next-Generation Firewall (NGFW): Bi-directional log sharing (syslog/CEF/LEEF), shared threat intelligence (STIX/TAXII), and ability to receive IPsec tunnels from the NGFW for on-premises traffic steering to the SASE PoP.	Out of scope
3.9.4 Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR): API-based integration to receive endpoint risk signals. When the EDR flags a compromised endpoint, the SASE platform must dynamically adjust the access policy (e.g., restrict to isolation-only browsing or block entirely).	In-scope
3.9.5 SIEM / SOAR: Real-time log export via syslog (CEF), API, or native connector to enterprise SIEM. Support for common platforms (Splunk, Microsoft Sentinel, QRadar, FortiSIEM, Elastic). SOAR integration for automated response workflows.	In-Scope
3.9.6 Unified Endpoint Management (UEM/MDM): Query device compliance status (encryption, OS version, patch level) from UEM platforms (Intune, Jamf, VMware WS1) as an input to SASE policy decisions.	Out of scope
3.9.7 Threat Intelligence Platform (TIP): Ingest external threat intelligence feeds (STIX/TAXII 2.1) and institutional indicators of compromise (IoCs) for custom blocklist enforcement.	STIX – out of scope, API integration supported.
3.9.8 ITSM / Ticketing: API integration with ServiceNow, IVANTI, or equivalent ITSM for automated ticket creation on security alerts, and policy violations.	Out of scope

3.9.9 Integrate Microsoft Data Loss Prevention (DLP) with the SASE platform to enforce consistent data protection policies across web, cloud, and private application traffic.	In-scope
3.9.10 Integrate Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps (CASB) with the SASE solution for cloud application visibility, SaaS security, risk-based access control, and policy enforcement.	In-Scope
3.9.11 Single sign-on: Integration with Windows AD, Microsoft Exchange Server and Terminal Server Agent, RADIUS Accounting message for wireless users, and captive portal authentication for wired users.	Out of scope
3.9.12 (Optional ZTNA) Privileged Access Management (PAM) Integration: If HCT deploys a PAM solution, the ZTNA platform must support integration via API or SAML to enforce PAM-brokered sessions for RDP/SSH access to sensitive servers. ZTNA session recording logs must be exportable to the PAM platform.	Out of scope
3.9.13 (Optional ZTNA) DNS-Based Application Routing: The ZTNA platform must support private DNS resolution so that published applications can be accessed via their internal FQDN (e.g., erp.hct.local) rather than requiring IP based configuration. The platform must integrate with HCT's internal DNS servers for name resolution of private application FQDNs.	In-Scope.
3.9.14 (Optional ZTNA) Service Ticket / Approval Workflow Integration: The ZTNA platform should support integration with ITSM (Ivanti or equivalent) for access request workflows, enabling users to request time-limited ZTNA access to specific applications through an approval workflow that automatically provisions and de-provisions access upon approval/expiry.	Out of scope

ZDX Implementation – configure up 15 monitored applications

The implementation partner shall:

- Configure critical Internet/SaaS application monitoring.
- Configure Web and cloud path probes.
- Endpoint & Device Health Monitoring
- Network Performance Monitoring
- Alerts & Threshold Configuration

Legacy Proxy Retirement

- Support HCT with retirement of the existing on-premises Zscaler proxy.

Documentation & Knowledge Transfer

The implementation partner shall provide:

- As-built architecture and configuration document.




- Administrator/operations knowledge-transfer sessions.

Optional - ZPA / ZTNA Implementation

Optional ZTNA / Private Application Access – Implementation Scope

The implementation partner shall design, configure, integrate, test and commission Zscaler Private Access (ZPA) for up to 200 designated HCT users, providing secure, application-level access to approved private applications hosted in the Primary DC, DR DC and approved cloud environments without exposing internal networks or providing broad VPN-style access.

- Conduct a technical workshop to understand the requirements and prepare ZPA design document.
- Deploy and configure up to 6 ZPA App Connectors: 2 in Primary DC, 2 in DR DC and up to 2 in cloud, with outbound-only connectivity, redundancy and failover validation.
- Onboard up to 30 applications including Browser based application /application segments including web, RDP, SSH, thick-client, database and selected file-service use cases.
- Configure least-privilege application segmentation so users receive access only to explicitly authorized applications and not to the underlying network or subnet.
- Integrate with IdP/Identity sources for user/group synchronization and configure up to 15 ZPA access policies based on user/group mappings.
- Configure up to 5 device-posture profiles/checks and applicable posture-based access policies using available endpoint security, domain, certificate and device-management attributes.
- Enable ZPA service entitlements on the ZCC and support production rollout for up to 200 named users, including a pilot for up to 25 users.
- Configure clientless browser-based ZTNA for up to 10 supported web applications, included within the overall 30-application limit.
- Configuring log Forwarding to SIEM.
- Perform pilot, UAT, application-access validation, unauthorized-access testing, App Connector HA/DR failover testing and production acceptance.
- Provide as-built documentation, and knowledge-transfer sessions.

Scope Limitations

The scope excludes onboarding beyond 30 applications, users beyond 200, VPN replacement, application code modification, unsupported protocol remediation, custom API/middleware development, PAM implementation, Customer-side firewall/routing/DNS redesign, endpoint remediation, VM/cloud infrastructure provisioning and individual BYOD support. Customer-side changes to IAM, PAM, DNS, SIEM, network and endpoint platforms shall be performed by the respective HCT teams.

Any requirement exceeding the above quantities shall be handled through additional professional services or the formal Change Request process.

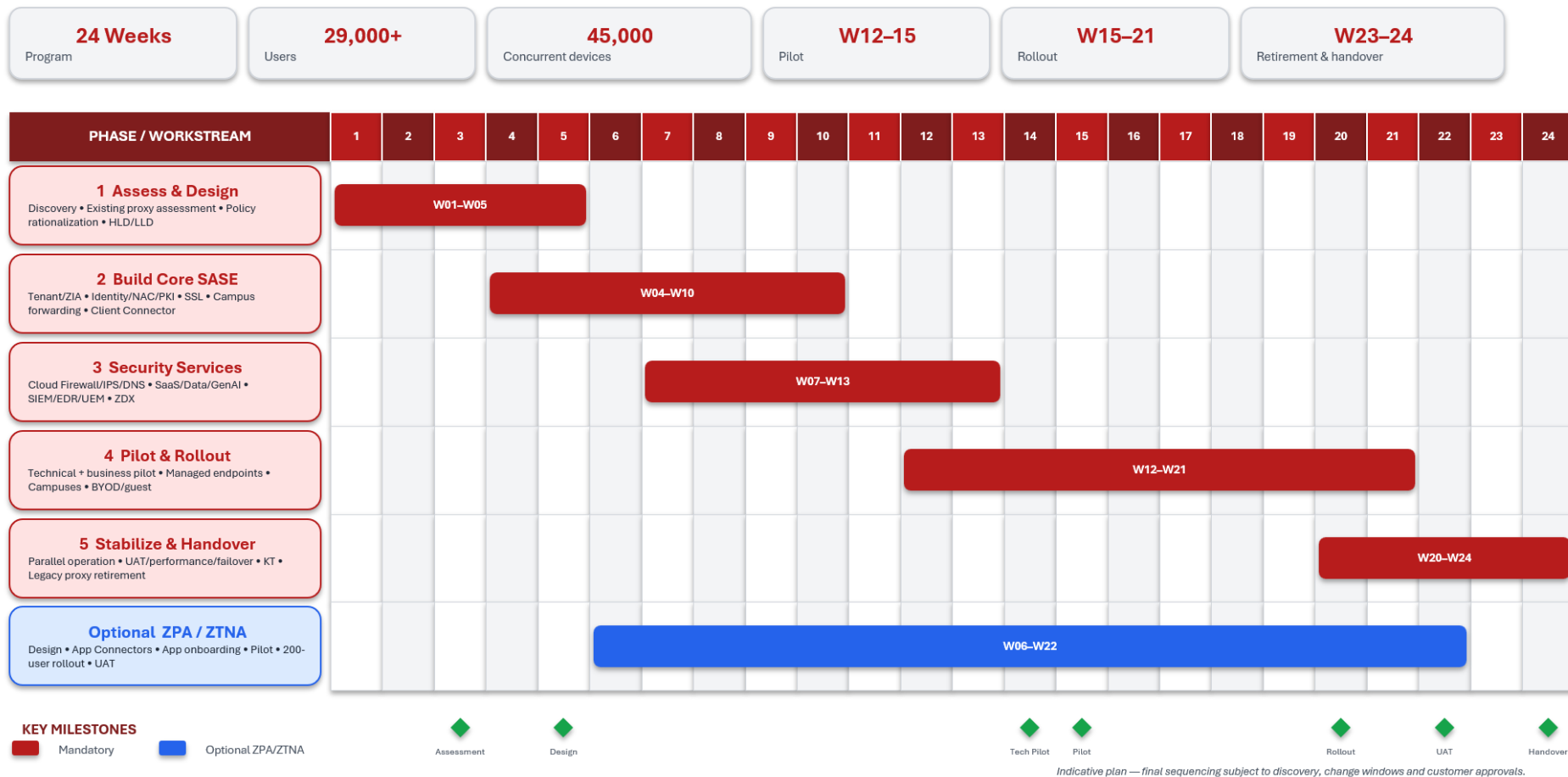


2.1.1 Indicative Implementation Project Plan

The below is an indicative implementation timeline included for customer reference. The actual project timeline will be mutually agreed during the project kick off.

Zscaler SASE Implementation & Migration Plan

24-week phased modernization from existing on-premises Zscaler web proxy to enterprise Zscaler Zero Trust SASE



Below table provide high level dependencies and sequencing of the implementation plan.

ID	Phase / Activity	Scope	Start	End	Owner / Lead	Dependency	Key Deliverable	W0 1	W0 2	W0 3	W0 4	W0 5	W0 6	W0 7	W0 8	W0 9	W1 0	W1 1	W1 2	W1 3	W1 4	W1 5	W1 6	W1 7	W1 8	W1 9	W2 0	W2 1	W2 2	W2 3	W2 4	
1	Project Initiation & Discovery	Mandatory	1	2	Project Manager / Zscaler Architect		Project Charter, Project Plan, Discovery Report																									
2	Existing Zscaler Web Proxy Assessment	Mandatory	1	3	Zscaler Architect	1	Current-State Assessment & SASE Readiness Report																									
3	Policy Rationalization & Migration Mapping	Mandatory	2	4	Security Architect / Zscaler Engineer	2	Zscaler-to-ZIA Policy Migration Matrix																									
4	HLD / LLD & Traffic Flow Design	Mandatory	2	5	Solution Architect	1,2	HLD, LLD, Traffic Flows, Integration Design																									
5	Zscaler Tenant / ZIA Base Build	Mandatory	4	7	Zscaler Engineer	4	Configured ZIA Tenant & Admin Baseline																									
6	Identity / NAC / PKI Integration	Mandatory	5	8	Identity / Network / Security Teams	4,5	Identity, NAC & Certificate Integration																									
7	SSL/TLS Inspection Configuration	Mandatory	6	9	Zscaler Engineer / PKI Team	5,6	SSL Inspection Policy & Exception Matrix																									
8	Campus Traffic Forwarding Design & Build	Mandatory	6	10	Network Team / Zscaler Engineer	4,5	GRE/IPsec Forwarding & Failover Configuration																									
9	Zscaler Client Connector Configuration	Mandatory	7	10	Endpoint / UEM Team	5,6	Client Connector Profiles & Deployment Package																									
10	Cloud Firewall / IPS / DNS Security	Mandatory	7	11	Security Team / Zscaler Engineer	5	FWaaS, IPS & DNS Security Baseline																									
11	SaaS / Data / GenAI Security Controls	Mandatory	8	12	Security Team / Data Security Team	5,6	CASB / GenAI Policy Baseline																									
12	SIEM / EDR / UEM / TIP Integration	Mandatory	9	12	SOC / Endpoint / Security Teams	5,6	Operational Integration Configuration																									
13	ZDX Digital Experience Monitoring	Mandatory	10	13	Zscaler Engineer / Operations	5,9	ZDX Dashboards & Monitoring Baseline																									
14	Technical Pilot	Mandatory	12	14	Project Team / Pilot Users	6-13	Technical Pilot Report																									
15	Business Pilot & Remediation	Mandatory	14	15	Business / Project / Security Teams	14	Business Pilot Acceptance & Remediation Log																									
16	Managed Endpoint Rollout	Mandatory	15	20	UEM / Endpoint Team	15	Phased Client Connector Rollout																									
17	Campus Migration Rollout	Mandatory	16	20	Network Team / Zscaler Engineer	15	Campus Migration Completion Reports																									
18	BYOD / Guest Migration Rollout	Mandatory	17	21	NAC / Network / Security Teams	15,17	BYOD Migration & Policy Validation																									
19	Parallel Operation & Stabilization	Mandatory	20	22	Operations / Zscaler Engineer	16-18	30-Day Stabilization & Tuning Report																									
20	UAT / Performance / Failover Testing	Mandatory	21	22	Customer UAT / Project Team	16-19	UAT, Performance & HA/Failover Report																									
21	Documentation & Knowledge Transfer	Mandatory	22	23	Zscaler Architect / Operations	20	As-Built, Runbooks, KT Completion																									
22	Legacy Proxy Retirement	Mandatory	23	24	Network / Security / Operations	19,20,21	Legacy Proxy Retirement Report																									
23	Final Handover & Project Closure	Mandatory	24	24	Project Manager	22	Final Acceptance & Closure Certificate																									
24	ZPA / ZTNA Design & App Discovery	Optional	6	8	Zscaler Architect / App Owners	4,6	Optional ZPA HLD/LLD & App Catalogue																									
25	ZPA App Connector Deployment (DC/DR)	Optional	8	10	Zscaler Engineer / Server Team	24	Optional HA App Connector Deployment																									
26	ZPA Policy, Posture & Application Onboarding	Optional	10	13	Zscaler Engineer / IAM / PAM	25	Optional ZPA Policies & Application Segments																									
27	ZPA Pilot & Failover Testing	Optional	13	15	Project Team / Pilot Users	26	Optional ZPA Pilot & Failover Report																									
28	ZPA Production Rollout (200 Users)	Optional	16	20	Endpoint / App / Security Teams	27	Optional ZPA Production Rollout																									
29	ZPA UAT & Handover	Optional	20	22	Customer UAT / Operations	28	Optional ZPA UAT & Handover																									

***Note:** Help AG is not liable for any delays from customer/ third party/ principal vendor. Any applicable penalty metrics to be mutually agreed. All penalties applicable to delays solely attributed to Help AG is to be capped to 10% of the contract value only.



2.1.1.1 Key Milestones.

MILESTONES & DELIVERABLES				
Milestone	Description	Target Week	Scope	Acceptance / Output
M1	Discovery Complete	W03	Mandatory	Current-state and readiness assessment approved
M2	HLD / LLD Approved	W05	Mandatory	Target architecture and traffic flows approved
M3	Core ZIA Build Complete	W11	Mandatory	ZIA, SSL, FWaaS, DNS and forwarding baseline complete
M4	Technical Pilot Complete	W14	Mandatory	Technical pilot exit criteria achieved
M5	Business Pilot Accepted	W15	Mandatory	Business pilot approved for production rollout
M6	Managed & Campus Rollout Complete	W20	Mandatory	Primary user and campus migration waves complete
M7	UAT / Failover Accepted	W22	Mandatory	UAT, performance, failover and stabilization accepted
M8	Legacy Proxy Retired	W24	Mandatory	Legacy proxy retirement approved
M9	Project Closure	W24	Mandatory	Final handover and project acceptance
O1	ZPA Design Approved	W08	Optional	Optional ZPA architecture and app catalogue approved
O2	ZPA Pilot Complete	W15	Optional	Optional ZPA pilot and failover tests completed
O3	ZPA UAT / Handover	W22	Optional	Optional ZPA production acceptance

2.1.1.2 Key Project Deliverables

KEY PROJECT DELIVERABLES BY WORKSTREAM				
Workstream	Deliverables	Timeline	Scope	Acceptance
Discovery	Project Charter, project plan, discovery report, requirements traceability matrix	W01-W03	Mandatory	Customer approval

Architecture	HLD, LLD, traffic flows, integration architecture, security policy design	W02-W05	Mandatory	Design sign-off
Migration	Policy rationalization matrix, migration runbook, rollback plan	W02-W15	Mandatory	Migration approval
Implementation	ZIA, SSL, FWaaS, DNS, Client Connector, campus forwarding configuration	W04-W20	Mandatory	Technical validation
Security Integration	IdP, NAC, EDR/XDR, UEM/MDM, SIEM/SOAR, TIP integration	W05-W12	Mandatory	Integration test
Testing	Pilot, UAT, performance, failover and stabilization reports	W12-W22	Mandatory	Acceptance
Operations	As-built, SOPs, runbooks, KT and troubleshooting guide	W22-W23	Mandatory	Operational handover
Legacy Retirement	Legacy proxy archive and retirement completion report	W23-W24	Mandatory	Written approval
ZTNA / ZPA	ZPA design, App Connector deployment, app catalogue, UAT and handover	W06-W22	Optional	Optional acceptance

***Note:** All document deliverables will be in English as per Help AG/ principal vendor templates/ formats.

Ap Bt



2.1.2 Sample CVs

Sample CVs & Certificates of our resources are attached as additional documents along with this proposal. These are indicative CVs only for reference & the actual resource CVs will be shared during the kick off.

2.1.3 Dependencies

Implementation is dependent upon:

- Zscaler licensing and tenant provisioning.
- UAE/GCC Zscaler service-edge availability and connectivity.
- Campus Internet-link readiness.
- NGFW/SD-WAN routing and tunnel configuration.
- IdP, RADIUS, NAC and PKI readiness.
- UEM/MDM availability for Client Connector rollout.
- SIEM/SOAR, EDR/XDR and TIP integration access.
- Availability of existing Zscaler configuration information.
- Application-owner participation in testing.
- HCT change, UAT and security-policy approvals.

2.1.4 Assumptions to Deliver the Scope of Work

- **Help AG Implementation Scope and Onboarding Boundary:** Help AG's implementation team will deliver the services defined within the agreed implementation scope, ensuring that the core Zscaler SASE functionalities are configured, integrated, tested, and validated. During the implementation phase, Help AG will onboard only the agreed number of applications, users, devices, and policies specified within the scope. Help AG will also develop and hand over the required configuration templates, deployment procedures, and operational playbooks/runbooks to enable repeatable onboarding and future expansion of the Zscaler SASE platform. Following the implementation and handover, the Customer, supported by the Resident Engineer, will be responsible for onboarding the remaining users, devices, applications, and policies using the approved baseline and playbooks. Any onboarding beyond the agreed implementation limits will be considered outside the fixed implementation scope unless otherwise agreed through the applicable change-control process.
- HCT currently operates an on-premises Zscaler web-proxy solution and does not have a full enterprise SASE platform.
- Zscaler is the selected target SASE technology platform.
- Approximately 29,000+ users and up to 45,000 concurrent devices are within the target design.
- Existing local Internet breakout links and network infrastructure are available and operational.
- Required Zscaler subscriptions for ZIA, ZDX, Data Security, Browser Security and optional ZPA are provided as part of the agreed BOQ.
- HCT will provide administrative access to existing proxy, identity, NAC, NGFW, PKI, SIEM and endpoint systems.
- HCT will provide required CA certificates and support enterprise certificate distribution.
- Optional ZPA/ZTNA shall only be implemented if commercially awarded.

Access:

- This proposal is based on an unrestricted access to the installation location for all consultants/engineers involved during normal business hours of 8 am till 5 pm.

Location:

- All services are to be delivered on one location/datacenter within the UAE
- All Help AG professional services for implementation will be delivered in a **hybrid manner (onsite & remote)**. All onsite activities will be mutually agreed.
- All services for Help AG Managed Security Controls will be delivered **remotely** only. Customer is requested to enable the remote access accordingly to provide the services as applicable.

Work Environment:

- A dedicated desk and workstation with proper power and network connection with internet access and access to devices in scope of implementation / or a dedicated desk and network connection where a Help AG laptop can be connected. The connection should have internet access and access to devices in scope of implementation.

Technical Requirements:

- During ongoing implementation technical requirements such as, but not limited to, IP addresses, VLAN's, cabling, network ports, power, application details etc. required to perform the installation are to be provided by customer within maximum 24 hours from request in order to avoid delay in delivery or scope deviation.

Non-Technical Requirements:

- Special security, health and safety matters applicable to the Location where Services are to be provided.
- Requirements imposed by law or by any professional body which must be satisfied if the Help AG employee is to execute the Services.
- Storage facilities for devices/equipment.

Below is the Scope Limitations section for the Zscaler SASE SOW:

- The implementation scope is limited to the Zscaler SASE capabilities, licenses, user quantities, locations, integrations and optional components explicitly included in the approved BOQ and SOW.
- Existing LAN, WLAN, WAN, MPLS, SD-WAN, Internet circuits, NGFW, NAC, IAM, EDR/XDR, SIEM/SOAR, UEM/MDM and PKI platforms will not be replaced or redesigned except for configuration changes required to integrate with Zscaler. Configuration changes on the other end integrated devices is the responsibility of HCT platform administrators.
- ISP bandwidth upgrades, carrier changes, WAN redesign, campus network refresh and remediation of underlying network-performance issues are excluded.
- Migration will cover supported and approved configurations from the existing on-premises Zscaler web-proxy environment; unsupported, obsolete, duplicate or unused policies may be excluded following customer approval.
- Application redesign, source-code modification, certificate-pinning remediation and changes to third-party SaaS or business applications are outside scope.
- Support for legacy applications, protocols, operating systems or devices not supported by the proposed Zscaler platform is excluded unless specifically agreed through change control.
- Zscaler Client Connector deployment is limited to supported operating systems and customer-managed endpoints accessible through the agreed UEM/MDM/software-distribution mechanism.
- BYOD implementation is limited to agreed network, browser, identity and traffic-forwarding mechanisms; installation, configuration or troubleshooting of personally owned devices is not included.
- SSL/TLS inspection is limited to technically compatible applications and traffic. Applications using certificate pinning, unsupported encryption, mutual TLS or regulatory/privacy restrictions may require approved bypasses.

- Policy migration does not guarantee exact one-to-one feature equivalence between the existing proxy and the target Zscaler cloud services; functional differences will be documented and addressed through approved alternatives.
- Performance targets are subject to customer LAN/WLAN conditions, endpoint health, ISP latency, Internet routing, SaaS provider performance and Zscaler service-edge availability.
- The scope does not include guaranteeing application response times for services hosted or operated by third parties.
- Customer-specific scripts, API development, custom software development or bespoke integration connectors are excluded unless explicitly included.
- Integration scope is limited to standard Zscaler-supported APIs, protocols and connectors for the agreed IdP, NAC, NGFW, EDR/XDR, SIEM/SOAR, UEM/MDM, TIP and ITSM systems.
- Troubleshooting or remediation of defects within third-party platforms is excluded; the implementation team will provide reasonable integration troubleshooting and evidence to the responsible vendor/team.
- SIEM integration is limited to configuring agreed Zscaler log feeds and validating receipt; creation of extensive SIEM correlation rules, SOC use cases, dashboards or SOAR playbooks is excluded unless separately scoped.
- Data classification, enterprise DLP policy redesign and remediation of existing data-governance issues are excluded unless Zscaler Data Security professional services are specifically included.
- ZPA/ZTNA, App Connectors, private application onboarding, PAM integration and clientless private access are optional and excluded from mandatory scope unless awarded.
- Zscaler Zero Trust Branch, Branch Connector and Cloud Connector deployment is excluded unless specifically included in the final architecture and BOQ.
- Application onboarding under ZPA, if selected, is limited to the agreed number of applications and users; additional applications, locations or user volumes will require change control.
- The project does not include replacement of existing VPN infrastructure unless ZPA migration and legacy VPN retirement are explicitly included.
- Hardware procurement, installation, rack-and-stack, structured cabling and physical data-center activities are excluded unless specifically identified.
- Certificate Authority redesign, PKI migration and HSM implementation are excluded; the customer shall provide required certificates, trust chains and PKI services.
- End-user communication campaigns, training for all end users and service-desk staffing are excluded unless explicitly included; the project will provide administrator/operations knowledge transfer as defined in the SOW.
- OEM product defects, feature limitations and service outages are governed by Zscaler OEM support and SLA terms and are not considered implementation-partner defects.
- Legacy Zscaler proxy retirement will only be performed after successful migration and written customer approval; physical disposal or commercial termination of legacy subscriptions is excluded unless specifically requested.
- Migration activities are dependent on approved change windows. Delays caused by unavailable customer resources, application owners, third-party vendors or change approvals may require schedule adjustment.
- Any significant requirement, site, user population, integration, application, security feature or configuration not identified during discovery and not included in the approved SOW will be handled through the formal Change Request process.

2.1.5 Out of Scope

- Upgrade or configuration of any systems not mentioned in the BOQ or in the “In Scope” Section.
- Network cabling or provisioning of power and rack-space.
- Labeling of devices.

- Installing client end user software unless specified in the “In Scope” Section.
- Training or training materials, unless specified in the “In Scope” Section.
- Any access permission changes on the network infrastructure is responsibility of customer.
- Configuring new applications or adding new features to the current configuration not mentioned in SOW section.
- Activating any new software modules not mentioned in SOW section.
- Providing any items not mentioned in the bill of material, example: Cables, SSL certificates etc.
- Testing application
- Generating application traffic required for solution tuning.
- Further fine tuning after the traffic has been generated from the previous stage
- Providing consultation on bad coding practices or performing any type of vulnerability assessment on the application, unless specified in the Bill of Material
- Any configuration changes on existing infrastructure, example: Switches, Routers, Firewall Rulesets, Application or web-server configuration.
- Replacement of campus LAN/WLAN infrastructure.
- Internet, MPLS or WAN bandwidth upgrades.
- Replacement of NGFW, SD-WAN, NAC or IAM infrastructure.
- Replacement of EDR/XDR, SIEM/SOAR or UEM/MDM.
- Application code modification to address certificate pinning.
- Remediation or modernization of unsupported legacy applications.
- Enterprise endpoint operating system upgrades.
- Changes to third-party SaaS applications beyond required integrations.
- ZPA, Zero Trust Branch or Cloud Connector deployment unless specifically included.

2.2 Post Implementation Support Services

The Resident Engineer shall be onsite at the HCT location during agreed business hours, 8 hours per business day, 5 business days per week, excluding HCT-recognized public holidays unless otherwise contractually agreed. The engineer should be the primary day-to-day Zscaler technical contact and work closely with the Customer's Network, Security, SOC, IAM, NAC, Endpoint/UEM, PKI, SIEM and Service Desk teams.

Activities requiring support outside the 8x5 resident-engineer window, including P1/P2 incidents, major service outages or emergency escalations, should be handled through 24x7 Managed Security Controls (SMC) service and Zscaler OEM support, rather than relying solely on the onsite Resident Engineer.

2.2.1 Resident Engineer Responsibilities

As part of the scope of work Help AG Resident Engineer deployed at HCT will be perform day to day operational activities, below is the list of activities that the RE is responsible for:

- Perform daily checks of ZIA, Client Connector, ZDX, GRE/IPsec tunnels, authentication, logging, integrations and subscribed Zscaler services; identify degradation and initiate corrective/escalation actions.
- Perform approved day-to-day administration of the Zscaler tenant, including locations, groups, policy objects, administrator roles, profiles and customer-specific configurations.
- Manage URL filtering, application control, file controls, web-access policies, allow/block lists, custom categories and Internet-security exceptions.
- Administer Cloud Firewall, IPS, DNS Security, malware/phishing protection, IP/FQDN controls, Geo-IP, reputation and other customer-specific threat policies.
- Maintain SSL inspection and bypass policies, troubleshoot certificate-related issues and certificate-pinned applications, and coordinate CA/certificate activities with the Customer PKI team.

- Troubleshoot Client Connector installation, authentication, forwarding, posture, application bypass, trusted-network detection and connectivity issues; coordinate upgrades with endpoint/UEM teams.
- Monitor and troubleshoot GRE/IPsec forwarding, service-edge connectivity, routing, MTU/MSS, traffic steering and BYOD Internet-security policies across customer campuses.
- Perform first-level technical analysis of Zscaler-related incidents, resolve tenant/configuration issues, identify recurring problems and coordinate RCA and corrective actions.
- Open, track and manage Zscaler OEM support cases for suspected cloud-platform or product issues, provide diagnostic information, follow up on escalations and validate resolution.
- Act as the technical escalation point for Customer L1/L2 service desk teams for Zscaler-related user, endpoint, application, Internet and security-policy incidents.
- Implement approved additions, modifications and removals of web, firewall, DNS, SSL, application and security policies in accordance with Customer change-management procedures.
- Process approved URL, application, SSL, IP/FQDN and temporary security exceptions; maintain appropriate approvals, expiry dates and audit records.
- Periodically review rules and objects to identify obsolete, duplicate, unused, conflicting or overly permissive policies and recommend consolidation or removal.
- Review significant web, malware, phishing, DNS, firewall, IPS, botnet/C2 and other Zscaler security events and coordinate actionable findings with the Customer SOC.
- Troubleshoot SAML/OIDC/SCIM, AD/Entra ID authentication, user/group mappings and identity synchronization issues in coordination with Customer IAM teams.
- Monitor and troubleshoot customer-specific integrations with NAC, EDR/XDR and UEM/MDM, including device posture, risk information and Client Connector deployment dependencies.
- Monitor Zscaler log delivery to the Customer SIEM/SOAR platform, investigate missing or delayed logs and coordinate restoration of log forwarding.
- Monitor ZDX dashboards, user-experience scores, endpoint/network/service-edge paths and SaaS performance; investigate slow Internet or application experience.
- Troubleshoot business applications affected by Zscaler policies, SSL inspection, authentication, routing or Client Connector and coordinate resolution with application owners.
- Review latency, service-edge selection, tunnel health, Internet/SaaS performance and customer-visible service metrics and investigate abnormal performance conditions.
- Participate in approved change windows, implement Zscaler-side configuration changes, perform pre/post validation and support rollback when required.
- Support onboarding of approved new campuses, locations, user groups and network segments by configuring applicable tenant-side locations, forwarding and policies.
- Review relevant Client Connector releases, support testing, pilot deployment and phased rollout in coordination with the Customer endpoint-management team.
- Provide a daily health summary covering platform status, tunnels, integrations, major incidents, critical security alerts, open OEM cases, changes and pending Customer actions.
- Review incidents, changes, recurring problems, policy requests, performance issues, OEM tickets and planned activities with the Customer technical teams.
- Contribute technical information for monthly SLA/KPI, incident, problem, change, security, availability, performance and capacity/utilization reporting.
- Maintain as-built configurations, SOPs, troubleshooting guides, policy records, exception registers, configuration changes and known-error documentation.
- Provide continuous operational knowledge transfer, troubleshooting guidance and technical mentoring to Customer network, security, SOC and service-desk teams.
- Assist in providing authorized configuration evidence, security-policy extracts, administrative audit information and operational records for audits and assessments.



- Identify recurring operational issues, security-policy gaps, performance improvements and automation/optimization opportunities and recommend improvements to the Customer.

Applicable Resident Engineer Terms & Conditions:

- Minimum Term: 1 Year from the date of onboarding.
- The renewal prices (post the term covered in the Bill of Materials) are subject to change. Help AG shall communicate the renewal pricing, if required by the customer, at later stages.
- Onboarding time: Within 3 to 4 months from the date of signed PO. Any delay in candidate selection or security clearance will impact the timelines.
- Resident Engineer is eligible for annual leave of 24 working days, sick leaves of 10 working days.
- Help AG will provide a replacement engineer during the planned annual leave (24 working days). Any planned annual leave will be mutually agreed with customer. However, during any sick leaves, public holiday or any unplanned/ emergency leaves, a replacement engineer shall not be provided however the remote support will continue from Help AG MSC Services to ensure no impact to the customer services.
- When resident engineers are required to work on work outside of business hours/ public holidays they must be provided with a compensatory leave.
- Customer is liable to provide a 3 months' notice for renewal/termination of the resident engineer services.

2.2.2 Help AG Managed Security Controls Services

During the duration of the project Help AG will leverage our vast experience of Managed Security Services to offer a Managed Security Controls service, delivered **remotely**, to cater to the technical needs in managing third-party security controls during the migration to cloud

2.2.2.1 Managed security Controls (MSC) - Scope

MSS Services OFFerings	Services and Add-On	Production Scope
<u>Managed Security Controls</u>	✓	
<u>Zscaler SASE Cloud</u>	✓	

2.2.2.2 Managed Security Controls (MSC) - Description

2.2.2.2.1 Service Description

Skilled resources are increasingly hard to find, hire and retain. Managing assets takes time, care and consumes valuable resources.

This suite of services provides Operations, Administration and Maintenance across a variety of Security Controls, namely:

Help AG works hard to find, hire and retain the best skilled engineers in the UAE. As a multi-award-winning Cybersecurity Services and Solutions and provider, Help AG is uniquely positioned to attract Cybersecurity talent.

MSC provides 24x7 health monitoring and management of Security Controls to ensure that your business critical applications stay available and secure. The service includes Problem, Incident and Change



Management, Patches/Upgrades/Fixes, Configuration Backup and Restoration, Vendor and License Management, 24x7 Support and access to Help AG's skilled engineering team.

The suite of MSC services does not include 24x7 Threat Detection and Incident Response – this capability is provided by the Help AG MDR Managed Security Service. When MSC is coupled with the Managed Detection & Response service organizations receive round-the-clock Operations, Administration and Management, as well Threat Detection and Incident Response from the Help AG CSOC.

In the table below are the MSC services that can be provided by Help AG.

The Services or Service elements included in this proposal is marked with this symbol: ✓

2.2.2.2.2 Service Matrix

MANAGED SECURITY CONTROLS – SERVICE ELEMENTS	IN-SCOPE
Tenant Administration & Configuration Management: Perform day-to-day administration of the customer Zscaler tenant, including RBAC, locations, user/group configurations, policy objects, configuration baselines, approved changes and configuration documentation.	✓
24x7 Service Health Monitoring & Daily Checks: Monitor customer-visible Zscaler services, Client Connector, tunnels, authentication, integrations, logging and security alerts; perform daily health checks and report service degradation or abnormalities.	✓
Security Policy Administration: Manage and optimize ZIA SWG, URL filtering, application control, Cloud Firewall, IPS, DNS Security, threat protection, allow/block lists and customer-approved policy exceptions.	✓
SSL/TLS Inspection Management: Administer SSL inspection policies, bypass/exemption rules and certificate-related configurations; troubleshoot application compatibility and coordinate certificate lifecycle activities with the customer PKI team.	✓
Client Connector Operations: Administer forwarding/app profiles, authentication, trusted-network detection, posture, bypass and anti-tamper settings; troubleshoot endpoint connectivity and coordinate controlled Client Connector upgrades with UEM/MDM teams.	✓
Campus & BYOD Connectivity Operations: Monitor and troubleshoot GRE/IPsec forwarding, service-edge connectivity, routing, MTU/MSS and traffic steering; maintain customer-specific BYOD security, segmentation and Internet access policies.	✓
Enterprise Security Integration Support: Operate and troubleshoot customer-specific integrations with IdP/AD, NAC, EDR/XDR, UEM/MDM, SIEM/SOAR and Threat Intelligence platforms, including monitoring log and identity/posture information flows.	✓
Incident, Problem & OEM Case Management: Provide P1–P4 incident handling, troubleshooting, escalation, recurring-problem analysis and RCA coordination; open, track and manage Zscaler OEM cases through restoration and closure.	✓
Change, Exception & Policy Optimization: Execute approved standard/emergency changes, URL/application exceptions and security-policy modifications; periodically identify obsolete, duplicate, conflicting or overly permissive rules for optimization.	✓



Digital Experience & Performance Monitoring: Use ZDX and available platform telemetry to monitor endpoint, network, Zscaler path and SaaS experience; investigate performance degradation and coordinate remediation with responsible customer/OEM teams.	✓
Reporting, Governance & Continual Improvement: Provide daily health reporting, monthly service reports, quarterly reviews, SLA/KPI tracking, audit evidence, capacity/license utilization reviews, operational documentation, knowledge-base updates and continual service-improvement recommendations.	✓
Optional Managed Services	
ZPA / ZTNA Operations: Administer ZPA application segments, segment/server groups, access policies, user/group assignments, private application access and customer-specific ZTNA configurations.	✓
ZPA App Connector Management: Monitor App Connector health, connector groups, Primary/DR connectivity and failover; troubleshoot connector-to-application communication and coordinate infrastructure issues with customer teams.	✓
Private Application Onboarding: Onboard new web, RDP, SSH and supported thick-client applications to ZPA within agreed service limits, including application discovery, segmentation, access-policy configuration and validation.	✓
SaaS / CASB & Shadow IT Operations: Monitor SaaS discovery and risk, maintain sanctioned/unsanctioned application classifications, tenant restrictions and customer-specific SaaS access controls.	✓
GenAI Security Operations: Monitor GenAI application usage and maintain approved/blocked AI application policies, user/group restrictions, upload controls and other customer-specific GenAI security controls.	✓
Data Security / DLP Operations: Administer licensed Zscaler DLP/Data Security policies, dictionaries, engines, sensitive-data controls, incidents and approved exceptions in coordination with the customer's data-security team.	✓
Browser Isolation / Zero Trust Browser Operations: Administer isolation policies for risky websites, unmanaged/BYOD users and selected applications, including read-only, download/upload, clipboard and browser-security restrictions.	✓
Advanced ZDX / Digital Experience Management: Perform proactive experience monitoring, synthetic testing, trend analysis, recurring degradation analysis and detailed user/application experience investigations.	✓
New Site / Business Unit Enablement: Configure Zscaler tenant-side locations, forwarding configurations, user/group policies and profiles for additional campuses, offices or business units within agreed service volumes.	✓
Advanced Security Optimization & Service Improvement: Conduct periodic security-policy posture assessments, advanced policy tuning, configuration optimization, security-use-case enhancements and agreed improvement initiatives.	✓
SERVICE MANAGEMENT	
Escalation Management	✓



2.2.2.2.3 Core Service Elements

The following sections describe the **Core Service** elements of Managed Security Controls.

2.2.2.2.3.1 Monitoring & Management for Health/Hygiene

This element of our **Managed Security Controls Services** covers the following activities:

- 24x7 Monitoring of general availability for each managed asset: CPU utilization, Memory utilization, Disk utilization, Interface utilization (depending on capabilities of the assets being monitored)
- Engagement between different Help AG functions operates seamlessly behind the scenes to initiate our Incident Management process and keep our clients informed of the status of any incidents.
- In case of changes in availability or indication of degradation of performance of monitored Controls, clients will be alerted 24x7 via telephone or email depending on agreed SLA and communication matrix.
- Incident Management (break-fix, RMA) in response to health or availability related events or incidents.

2.2.2.2.3.2 Managed Security Controls Administration & Management

Help AG Engineers are industry-leading support and configuration specialists, who provide constant and unique care for assets under management by Help AG.

The scope of activities for all Managed Security Controls are defined as per the list of elements below:

- Problem Assessment and Investigation (limited to Root Cause Analysis for P1/Critical Incidents)
- Change Assessment and Implementation (as the "Change Implementor")
- Policy and Configuration Management
- Policy Optimization and Tuning to ensure optimal resource utilization
- Patch/Update/Hotfix Implementation covering minor updates
- Configuration Backup and Restoration
- Technical Support Services (Vendor Support) provided by Help AG directly
- 1x Major Upgrade per year

2.2.2.2.4 SLAS

- Managed Services through remote delivery as per the RFP requirements
- Managed Services for onsite presence requirement in case if remote access is not working

SERVICE LEVEL	SERVICE PROVISION	RESPONSE TIME
24*7*2	Around the clock throughout the whole year via phone. On working days between 9AM and 5PM via e-mail and web.	Response to any incident through certified experts within 2 hours.

3 Compliance Table

Please refer to the compliance excel workbook "HCT SASE Compliance - Zscaler Response V1.0.docx" submitted along with this proposal.



3.1 Help AG Response to Evaluation Criteria

EVALUATION CRITERIA	HELP AG RESPONSE
1.1. Similar success stories and client reference	Please refer to Section 9.7 of our technical proposal for detailed customer references
1.2. Company Profile, Number of technically qualified engineers and their industry certifications	Help AG company profile is included in Section 9 of our technical proposal. Sample CVs of our resources along with a few certificates are attached as additional documents along with our proposal
1.3. Partnership level with Principal vendors	Please refer to Section 9.5 of our technical proposal for Help AG partnership certificate with Zscaler.
1.4. Well established service desk/helpdesk system, and dedicated support team	Please refer to Section 2.2.2 of our technical proposal for details on our Managed Security Controls services offered.
1.5. Financial stability and business viability	Help AG audited finance reports are attached as additional documents with our proposal
2.1. Dedicated Onsite / offsite with 100% backfill in absence of Resident Engineer.	Please refer to Section 2.2.1 for more details. Annual leave (1 time) backfill for RE is considered however no backfill will be provided during resource sick leave, public holidays/ unplanned leaves.
2.2. 24/7/365 availability of assigned resources across all HCT locations	Please note, we have only offered 1 RE (HCT Office in UAE) as part of our proposal. 24*7 support will be covered remotely by Help AG MSC as detailed in Section 2.2.2 of our technical proposal.
2.3. Detailed resumes	Sample CVs of our resources are attached as additional documents along with our proposal
2.4. Team certification level with supporting products	Sample CVs of our resources are attached as additional documents along with our proposal
3.1. Compliance with Technical Requirements outlined in section-1	Please refer to the compliance excel workbook "HCT SASE Compliance - Zscaler Response V1.0.docx" submitted along with this proposal.
3.2. Compliance with requirements outlined in Warranty and Support section-2	Please refer to the compliance excel workbook "HCT SASE Compliance - Zscaler Response V1.0.docx" submitted along with this proposal.
3.3. Compliance with requirements outlined in Security Requirement section-3	Please refer to the compliance excel workbook "HCT SASE Compliance - Zscaler Response V1.0.docx" submitted along with this proposal.




4 Help AG Review Comments to the RFP

RFP SECTION	DESCRIPTION	HELP AG COMMENT
2. Evaluation Criteria	Vendors' proposals will be evaluated against Technical Requirements Compliance matrix.XLS Attached appendix attached to this RFP	The specified excel is not attached in the RFP. Accordingly, the requirements mentioned in the excel is not considered as part of this Help AG proposal. Help AG will be able to submit the response to any specific compliance requirements, if any, once shared by HCT <u>However, Help AG Compliance response to the RFP requirements is attached as an additional document along with this proposal.</u>
2.2 a - 2	financial strength of the company to accept the quarterly payment over a period of 3 years	Kindly note, as detailed in our commercial proposal, quarterly payments are offered only for Help AG MSC & RE services. For products, licenses & vendor support, payments proposed are annual in advance.
6. Information Security Requirements Toolkit	6. Information Security Requirements Toolkit	The specified excel is not attached in the RFP. Accordingly, the requirements mentioned in the excel is not considered as part of this Help AG proposal. Help AG will be able to submit the response to any specific compliance requirements, if any, once shared by HCT
3.23.1 Limitation of Liability	3.23.1.1 The vendor's aggregate liability under this contract for direct damages shall not be less than two times (2x) the total annual contract value 3.23.1.2 The liability cap shall not apply to (unlimited liability for): (a) data breaches caused by vendor negligence, wilful misconduct, or failure to implement agreed security controls; (b) breach of confidentiality obligations; (c) intellectual property infringement; (d) the vendor's indemnification obligations; (e) fraud or wilful misconduct	3.23.1.1 – Help AG can accept a maximum liability cap of 5M USD only. 3.23.1.2 - Please either remove this clause entirely or please add " <i>provided that any recovery shall be limited to the actual and demonstrable loss or damage proven to have resulted from the relevant event.</i> "
3.23.2 Intellectual Property Ownership	3.23.2 Intellectual Property Ownership	Subject to principal vendor policies as well.




3.23.3 Termination Rights	3.23.3.1 Termination for Convenience: HCT may terminate this contract for convenience by providing 90 days written notice. The vendor shall invoke the Transition Assistance obligations in section 3.23.5.	Transition Assistance clauses are not applicable. Any transition assistance is to be limited during the contract term only. Any additional transition assistance required will be subject to a CR process with additional commercials. <u>In any case of termination, customer is liable for payment of all delivered licenses, vendor support for the entire contract term & Help AG services delivered until the effective date of termination.</u>
3.23.3 Termination Rights	3.23.3.2 Termination for Cause 3.23.3.3 Upon termination for cause, the vendor shall refund a pro-rata portion of any prepaid fees for the unexpired term, in addition to any applicable service credits and financial penalties.	In any case of termination, customer is liable for payment for delivered licenses, vendor support for the entire contract term & Help AG services delivered until the effective date of termination & any pro-rata refund is not applicable for licenses/ vendor support. Any changes to this will be subject to the principal vendor policies.
3.23.5 Transition Assistance and Exit Management	3.23.5 Transition Assistance and Exit Management	The requirements mentioned in this clause are subject to additional CR with revision in the commercials to cover the additional 12 month license & service cost. Free of cost transition assistance is to be limited only during the contract term & can be delivered during the notice period for such termination. The applicable scope & deliverables for such transition assistance will be mutually agreed.
3.23.6 Data Escrow	3.23.6 Data Escrow	Not applicable. Please exclude. This is subject to principal vendor policies
3.23.7 Cyber Insurance Cooperation	3.23.7 Cyber Insurance Cooperation	Not applicable. Please exclude. This is subject to principal vendor policies

Sp Bt



5 Project Management Matrix

Help AG Project Management has been **included** in this proposal

DELIVERABLE/PROCESS	Y/N	PROJECT MANAGEMENT SERVICES PURCHASED
Meeting MOMs		Formal MOM
Project Plan		Detailed Project Plan – MS Project
Project Charter		Includes Escalation - Matrix - Project Scope - Timeline - Approach - Assumptions & Constraints & Risks - Communication & Reporting - Roles & Responsibilities
Progress Reporting		Progress Report - Planned vs. Actual - Completed Milestones & Tasks - Upcoming Milestones (payments) - Recorded Delays
Change Management		- Change Management Sheet: recording and monitoring changes & impacted areas - Change Request Form
Risk Management		- Risk Log: risk identification, action, assignment, impact, probability, severity & monitoring impacted areas till closure - Risk status reporting on a weekly basis
Closure Meeting		Formal Closure Meeting confirming scope completion



6 Bill of Materials

6.1 Detailed BOQ - Mandatory - Zscaler Software Licenses & Subscriptions - 3 Years

Line	Item Number	Description	Qty.	Term	Total Price
A	Zscaler Security Solution Licenses & Subscriptions - 3 Years (START DATE: 1 JANUARY 27 / END DATE: 31 DECEMBER 29)				
A.1	ZIA-BIZ-EDITION	ZIA Business Edition	2,719	36 Months	Quoted
A.2	ZSC-LOG-EXTSUBS	Extended Log Store	2,719	36 Months	Quoted
A.3	ZDX-ADV-PLUS	ZDX Advanced Plus	2,719	36 Months	Quoted
A.4	ZS-CTP-SANDBOX	Zscaler Inline Cyber Threat Protection- Sandbox Advanced	2,719	36 Months	Quoted
A.5	ZS-CTP-FIREWALL	Zscaler Inline Cyber Threat Protection- Firewall Advanced	2,719	36 Months	Quoted
A.6	ZS-AI-ACCESS-PRE	Secure AI Access	2,719	36 Months	Quoted
A.7	ZT-BROWSER-ADV	Zero Trust Browser Advanced	29,022	36 Months	Quoted
A.8	ZS-TEST-ENV	Zscaler Test Environment	1	36 Months	Quoted
A.9	ZCES-SUP-PLUS	Zscaler Support Plus	1	36 Months	Quoted
A.10	ZCES-PRO-CREDITS	Professional Services Credits	90	36 Months	Quoted
A.11	ZCES-EDU-CREDIT	Zscaler Education Credits	16	36 Months	Quoted
B	Professional Services & Managed Services				
B.1	HEPS	Help AG Professional Services including Implementation and Configuration for Zscaler Solution as per the scope detailed in technical proposal	1	One Time Cost	Quoted
B.2	HAG-MSC-RE	Help AG on-site dedicated engineer for 3 years + replacement during annual leave (24 working days)	1	36 Months	Quoted
B.3	HAG-MSC-Service	Help AG Remote Managed Security Controls 24x7 health monitoring and management of Security Controls for 3 Yrs	1	36 Months	Quoted

Signature

6.2 Optional Items Requested

Optional Items Requested

Line	Item Number	Description	Qty.	Term	Total Price
O.1	ZS-ZPA-PLATFORM	Zscaler Private Access Platform	200	36 Months	Quoted
O.2	ZS-ZPA-VPN	ZPA for Legacy Apps (VOIP, S2C, etc.)	200	36 Months	Quoted
O.3	ZS-ZPA-SEGM	Zscaler Private Access: Segmentation	200	36 Months	Quoted
O.4	HEPS	Help AG Professional Services including Implementation and Configuration For Zscaler Solution as per scope of work included in technical proposal.	1	One Time Cost	Quoted

6.3 RFP Price Format

#	Component	Quantity	Unit Cost	Total Cost (AED)
1	Cloud SASE Platform	2,719	Quoted	Quoted
2	Integration and Professional Services	1	Quoted	Quoted
3	Manged Support Services	1	Quoted	Quoted
4	Training and Knowledge Transfer	1	INCLUDED	
5	OPTIONAL - ZTNA for Private Application Access	200	Quoted	Quoted

Signature



7 Appendix A: Zscaler SASE Solution

7.1 Zscaler Profile

Zscaler is a leading cloud enterprise security provider helping global businesses adopt zero trust for secure digital transformation.

Leveraging the largest security cloud on the planet, Zscaler anticipates, secures, and simplifies the experience of doing business for the world's most established companies.

We've achieved incredible growth since our founding in 2007, and today, we exist to create a world in which the exchange of information is always secure and seamless. It's our mission to anticipate, secure, and simplify the experience of doing business—transforming today and tomorrow.

The most trusted name in zero trust + AI

40%

of Global 2000
companies use Zscaler

500B+

transactions secured
daily by Zscaler

>70

Net Promoter Score

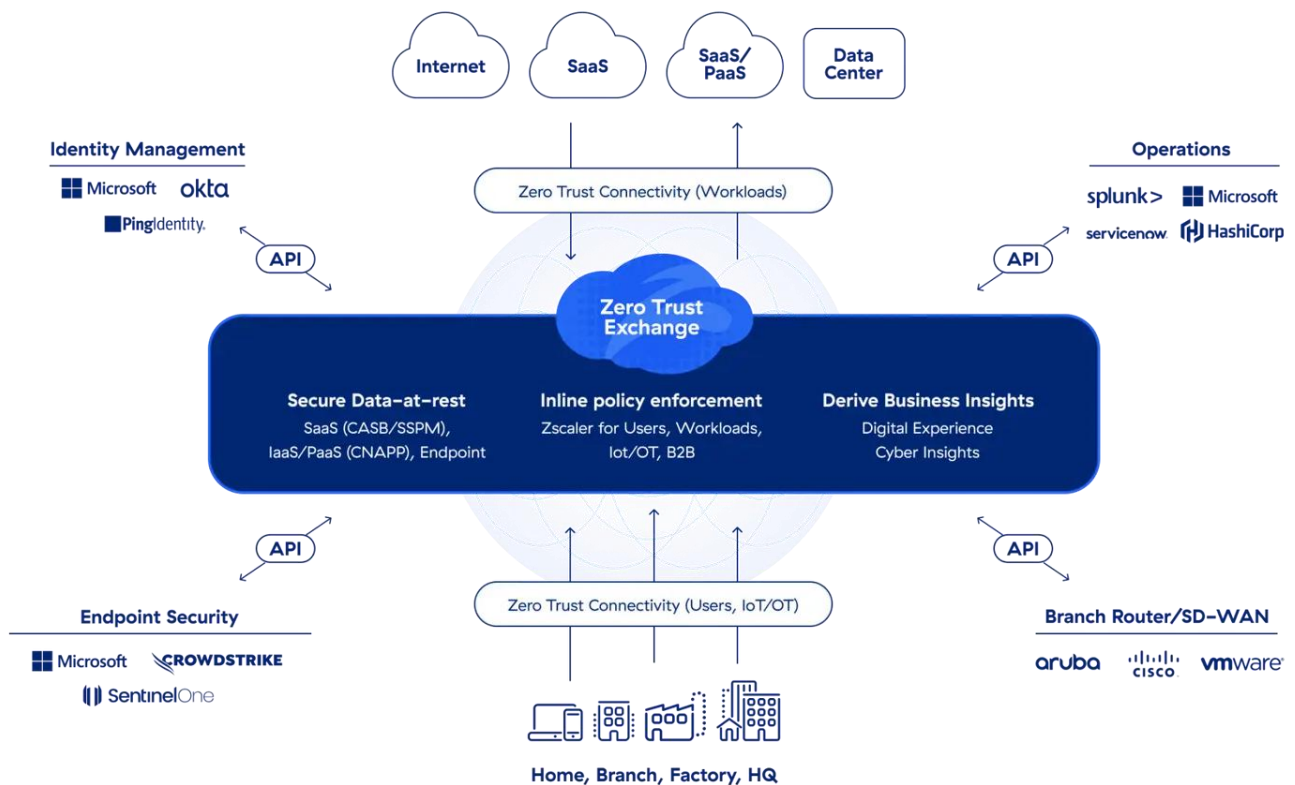
Zscaler was positioned as a clear Leader as a Secure Service Edge provider with a leading Zero Trust Network Access (ZTNA) solution from prominent industry analysts Gartner and Forrester:

- A Leader in the 2026 Gartner® Magic Quadrant™ for Security Service Edge (SSE) and Secure Access Server Edge (SASE)
<https://www.zscaler.com/gartner-magic-quadrant-security-service-edge-sse>
- A 2025 Customers' Choice in the Gartner® Peer Insights™ "Voice of the Customer" for Security Service Edge
<https://www.zscaler.com/campaign/2025-gartner-customers-choice-sse>
- A Leader in The Forrester Wave™: Secure Access Service Edge Solutions, Q3 2025.
<https://www.zscaler.com/campaign/forrester-wave-sase-solutions>
- Zscaler Gets 100% Security Efficacy Score in the 2025 CyberRatings SSE Test
<https://www.zscaler.com/campaign/zscaler-sse-test-results-2025>
- Zscaler Gets 100% Security Efficacy Score in the 2025 CyberRatings ZTNA Test
<https://www.zscaler.com/campaign/cyberratings-ztna-security-2025>
- A Leader in The Forrester Wave™: Security Service Edge Solutions, Q1 2024.
<https://www.zscaler.com/forrester-wave-security-service-edge>

Sp Bt



Our ecosystem of partners and integrations enables faster and more reliable deployments, facilitates easier and more agile operations, and enhances our customers' cloud experience.



7.2 Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA)

Securing today's cloud- and mobile-first enterprise requires a fundamentally different approach built on zero trust. Zscaler Internet Access, part of the Zscaler Zero Trust Exchange™, is the world's most deployed security service edge (SSE) platform, built on a decade of secure web gateway leadership.

Delivered as a scalable and resilient SaaS cloud security platform, ZIA eliminates legacy network security solutions to stop advanced attacks and prevent data loss with a comprehensive zero trust approach, offering:

- **Best-in-class, consistent security for today's hybrid workforce:** When you move security to the cloud, all users, apps, devices, and locations get always-on threat protection based on identity and context. Your security policy goes everywhere your users go.
- **Lightning-fast access with zero infrastructure:** Direct-to-cloud architecture ensures a fast, seamless user experience. This eliminates backhauling, improves performance and user experience, and simplifies network administration—with no physical infrastructure required.
- **AI-powered protection from the world's largest security cloud:** Inline inspection of all internet and SaaS traffic, including SSL decryption, with a suite of AI-powered cloud security services to stop ransomware, phishing, zero-day malware, and advanced attacks based on threat intelligence from 500 trillion daily signals.
- **Simplified management:** Using a cloud native security solution infused with AI, less hardware to manage, automation to streamline workflows, and business-focused policy creation frees up valuable time for your team to focus on strategic goals.

Zscaler Internet Access includes a comprehensive suite of AI-powered security and data protection services to help you stop cyberattacks and data loss. As a fully cloud-delivered SaaS solution, you can add new capabilities without any additional hardware or lengthy deployment cycles. The modules available as part of Zscaler Internet Access are:

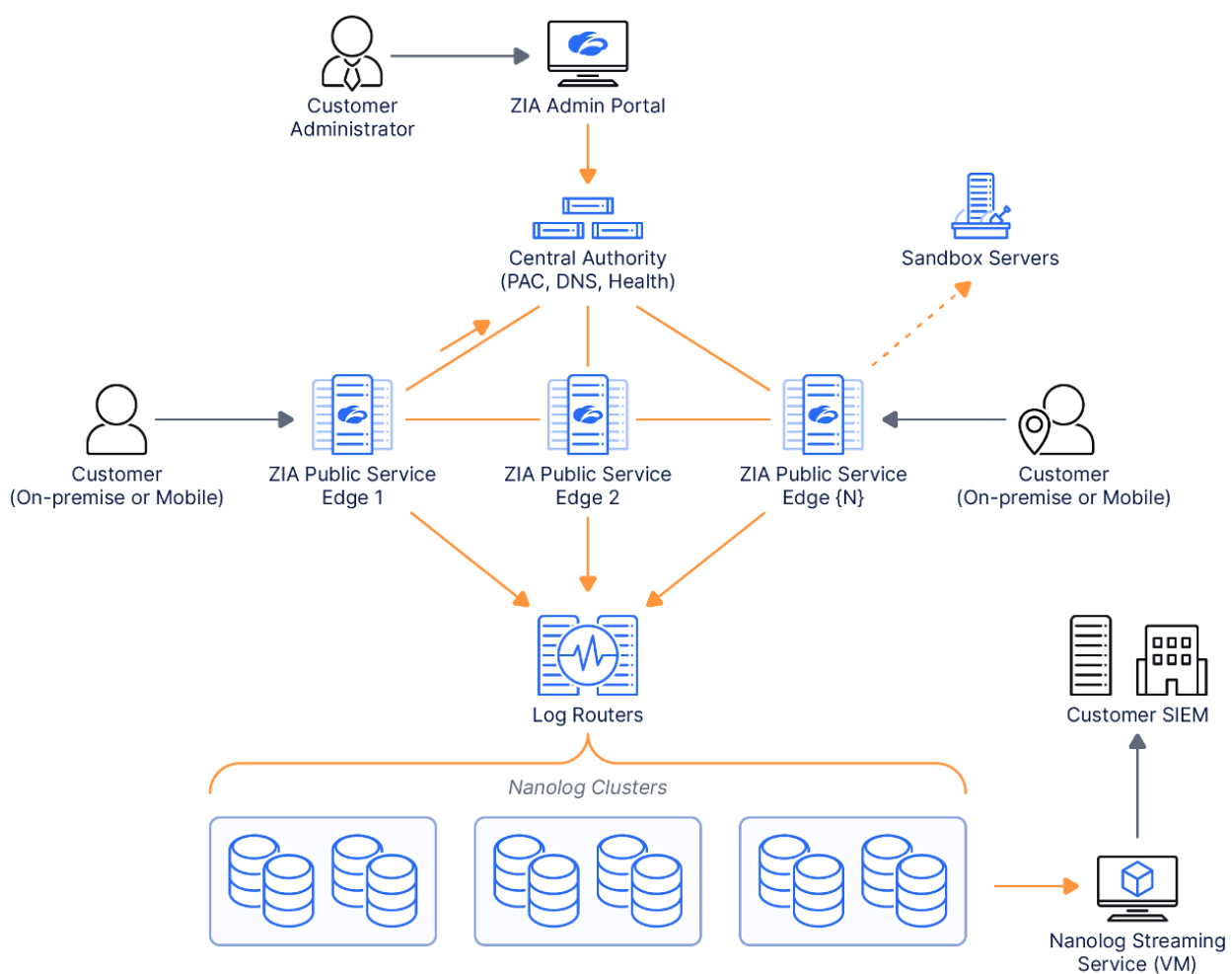
- **Cloud Secure Web Gateway (SWG):** Deliver a safe, fast web experience that eliminates ransomware, malware, and other advanced attacks with real-time, AI-powered analysis and URL filtering.
- **Cloud Access Security Broker (CASB):** Secure cloud apps with integrated CASB to protect data, stop threats, and ensure compliance across your SaaS and IaaS environments.
- **Cloud Data Loss Prevention (DLP):** Protect data in motion with full inline inspection and advanced measures like exact data match (EDM), optical character recognition (OCR), and machine learning.
- **Zscaler Firewall & cloud IPS:** Extend industry- leading protection to all ports and protocols and replace edge and branch firewalls with a cloud native platform.
- **Zscaler Sandbox:** Stop never-before-seen and elusive malware across web and file transfer protocols with AI-driven quarantine, sharing consistent and global protection across all users in real time.
- **AI-Powered Zero Trust Browser:** Make web-based attacks obsolete and prevent data loss by creating a virtual air gap between users, the web, and SaaS.



- **Zero Trust Branch Connectivity:** Reduce risk and complexity with non-routable branch and data center connectivity for users, servers, and IOT/OT devices.
- **DNS Security:** Optimize DNS security and performance for all users, devices, and applications, on all ports and protocols, anywhere in the world.

7.2.1 Understanding the ZIA Cloud Architecture

Zscaler operates the world's largest security-as-a-service (SECaaS) cloud platform to provide the industry's only 100% cloud-delivered web and mobile security solution. The highly scalable, global, multi-cloud infrastructure features three key components: the Zscaler Central Authority (CA), ZIA Public Service Edges, and Nanolog clusters.



7.2.1.1 Zscaler Central Authority

The Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA) Central Authority (CA) is the brain and nervous system of a Zscaler cloud. It monitors the cloud and provides a central location for software and database updates, policy and configuration settings, and threat intelligence. The CA consists of one active server and two servers in passive standby mode. The active CA replicates data in real time to the two standby CAs, so any of them can become active at any time. Each server is hosted in a separate location to ensure fault tolerance.

Signature

7.2.1.2 ZIA Public Service Edges

ZIA Public Service Edges are full-featured, inline internet security gateways that inspect all internet traffic bi-directionally for malware and enforce security and compliance policies.

An organization can forward its traffic to any ZIA Public Service Edge in the world or use the advanced geo-IP resolution capability of Zscaler to direct its users' traffic to the nearest ZIA Public Service Edge.

When the user moves to a different location, the policy follows the user, with the ZIA Public Service Edge downloading the appropriate policy. Customer traffic is not passed to any other component within the Zscaler infrastructure. The TCP stack on the ZIA Public Service Edge runs in user mode and is specially crafted to ensure multitenancy and data security. ZIA Public Service Edges never store any data to disk.

Log data generated for every transaction is compressed, tokenized, and exported over secure TLS connections to Log Routers that direct the logs to the Nanolog cluster, hosted in the appropriate geographical region, for each organization.

ZIA Public Service Edges are always deployed in active-active load balancing mode all over the world, and the CA monitors the health of ZIA Public Service Edges to ensure availability.

7.2.1.3 Nanolog Clusters

Nanolog clusters store transaction logs and provide reports. Each cluster consists of one active server and two servers in passive standby mode.

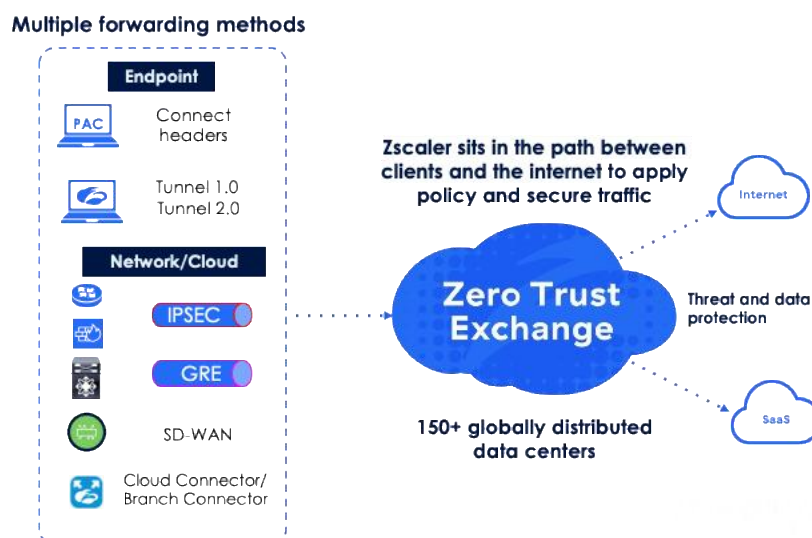
The active Nanolog immediately replicates data to the other two servers, so any of them can become active at any time, with no data loss. Each Nanolog server is hosted in a separate location to ensure fault tolerance.

Every second, a Nanolog cluster receives logs from all over the world, correlates them to a specific customer organization, and writes them to disk for high-speed retrieval of reporting and analytics.

A Nanolog cluster processes up to 1.2+ billion logs per day. Additionally, Zscaler offers a Nanolog Streaming Service (NSS), which uses a virtual appliance to stream web and firewall traffic logs in real time from the Zscaler Nanolog to the customer's security information and event management (SIEM) system.

7.2.2 Traffic Forwarding

Zscaler supports the following traffic forwarding mechanisms.



Depending on your environment and requirements, you can choose one or a combination of the following traffic forwarding methods. Zscaler recommends that you use a combination of tunneling, PAC files, Zscaler Client Connector, and Zscaler Cloud Connector, to forward traffic to the Zscaler service.

7.2.2.1 Zscaler Client Connector

Zscaler recommends that you install Zscaler Client Connector on your users' devices to protect their web traffic when they are accessing the internet from an unknown location (i.e., remote user).

With Zscaler Client Connector's internet security feature, you can protect your users' web traffic even when they are outside your corporate network. The app forwards user traffic to the Zscaler service and ensures that your organization's security and access policies are enforced wherever they might be accessing the internet from. The app automatically detects when the user is no longer within the secure network, then automatically creates a connection to the Zscaler service from an unknown location.

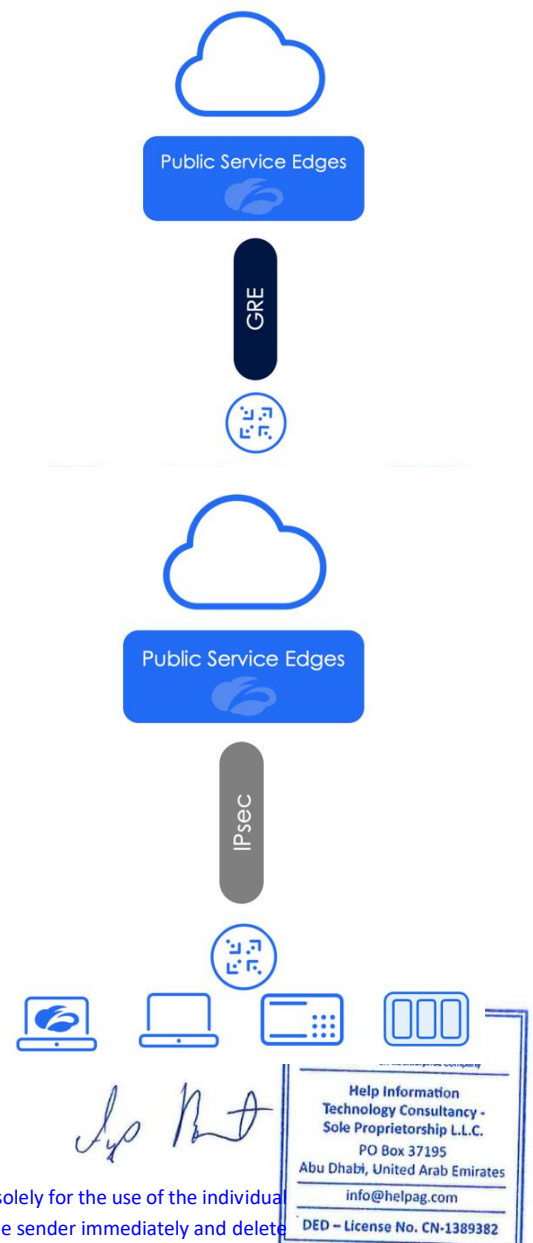


7.2.2.2 GRE Tunnels

A GRE tunnel can be used for forwarding internet-bound traffic from your corporate network to the Zscaler service.

If your organization has an internal router or switch that supports GRE and its egress port has a static address, you can configure a GRE tunnel.

Zscaler recommends that you configure two GRE tunnels from an internal router behind the firewall to the ZIA Public Service Edges: a primary tunnel to a ZIA Public Service Edge in one data center and a secondary tunnel to a ZIA Public Service Edge in another data center. These deployments provide visibility into internal IP addresses, which can be used for security policies and logging.



7.2.2.3 IPSec Tunnels

IPSec is a suite of protocols that provide network-layer security to a Virtual Private Network (VPN). If your router does not support GRE or if you use dynamic IP addresses, you can configure IPSec VPN tunnels.

Zscaler recommends that you configure two IPSec tunnels from an internal router behind the firewall to the ZIA Public Service Edges: a primary tunnel to a ZIA Public Service Edge in one data center and a secondary tunnel to a ZIA Public Service Edge in another data center. These deployments provide visibility into internal IP addresses, which can be used for security policies and logging.

7.2.2.4 PAC Files

A PAC file is a text file that directs the browser to forward traffic to a ZIA Public Service Edge. You can install a PAC file for each of your users to ensure coverage outside the corporate network.

If certain applications need to be excluded from the Zscaler service, it is easy to write an exclude statement in your PAC file to send traffic directly. Using PAC files allows you to set exceptions for forwarding your traffic, such as excluding intranet corporate sites from the Zscaler service.

7.2.2.5 Cloud/Branch Connector

Zscaler Cloud/Branch Connector works similarly to Zscaler Client Connector, using software-defined networking (SDN) principles. It relies on a unified Zero Trust Architecture for connectivity, security, and access to the Zscaler cloud. It works by establishing zero trust access for server-to-server traffic, east-west traffic in a public cloud, IT/OT networks, and data centers.

Cloud Connector simplifies traffic forwarding to the Zscaler service by securing server access to the internet and providing highly secure and simplified access to the Zscaler cloud. Using Cloud Connector, you can forward specific web traffic or application traffic through the Zscaler cloud.

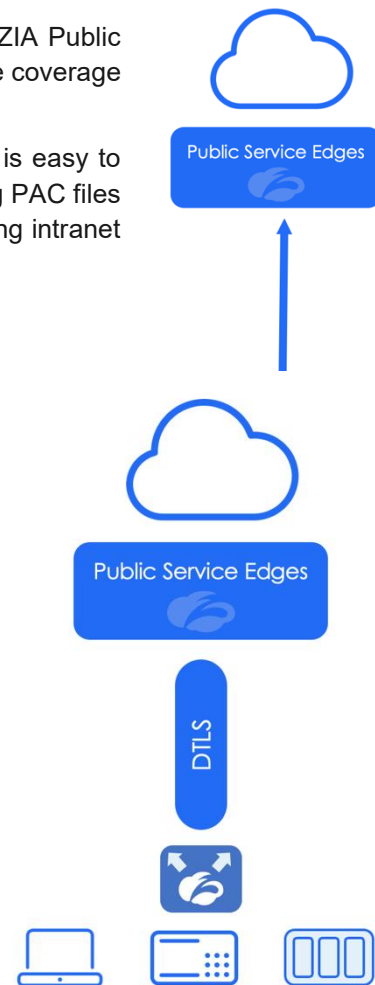
7.2.3 Zscaler Zero Trust Firewall

Zscaler Zero Trust Firewall delivers cloud-based protection for non-web traffic (DNS, FTP, RDP, SSH, Telnet and more), while Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA) delivers deep inspection for web traffic (HTTP/HTTPS). Together, they secure all ports and protocols including non-web applications and non-standard web, across all users, devices and locations.

Zero Trust Firewall improves connectivity and performance by enabling local internet breakout—eliminating the need for VPN backhauling or redundant on premises appliance stacks.

Zero Trust Firewall helps organizations easily meet regulatory standards while universally configuring, managing, and enforcing user- and application-aware threat protection and risk-based policies to ensure network and application visibility with a centralized policy management console. As a true firewall-as-a-service (FWaaS) solution—built from the ground up for the cloud—Zscaler Zero Trust Firewall eliminates the need for hardware provisioning or managed service models, delivering elastic scale and policy control without legacy limitations.

Zscaler Zero Trust Firewall provides forensically complete logs for every session, capturing detailed attributes such as user identity, device info, source and destination IPs, port, country, threat category, and more. This rich visibility across all users, devices, and locations eliminates the need for packet capture tools and ensures organizations have access to the right information at the right time.



7.2.3.1 Zscaler Cloud Native Firewall Key Capabilities

- Purpose-Built For Today's Digital World:** Zscaler Zero Trust Firewall ensures you can securely access the internet and handle all web and non-web traffic, across all ports and protocols, with infinite elastic scalability and unbeatable performance. Your users get consistent protection no matter what device

they're using or where they are—at home, HQ or branch offices, or on the road—without the cost, complexity, and performance limitations of traditional network security and next-generation firewall appliances.

- **Powered By an Adaptive Zero Trust Platform:** Stop compromising for static inspections, performance degradation, and capacity limits from physical firewall appliances. Built on a fully integrated, cloud-native platform, Zscaler Zero Trust Firewall elastically scales to handle cloud application traffic requiring long-lived connections while natively intercepting and inspecting TLS/SSL traffic—at scale—to detect malware hidden in encrypted traffic.
- **Transformative Hybrid and Branch Connections:** Evolve from costly and network-centric infrastructure to true cloud-delivered local internet breakouts. Route internet traffic locally to provide direct-to-cloud connections for consistently fast connections while delivering security and access controls for all ports and protocols. Without the need for any appliances to deploy or manage, this reduces MPLS backhauling costs and eliminates expensive and time-consuming patch management, coordination of outage windows, and policy management.
- **Ubiquitous Security for Modern Workforces:** Leverage real-time security updates informed by 500+ trillion daily signals and shared across the entire cloud each day for identical protection on any device wherever users connect. Bringing the entire security stack close to the user provides unparalleled user- and app-aware threat protection with dynamic, follow-me policies on and off the corporate network.
- **Always-On Blocking of Known Malicious Attacks:** Go where traditional solutions can't with a cloud-delivered intrusion prevention system (IPS) managed by Zscaler ThreatLabz. Through unlimited inline traffic inspection, including IoT/OT and encrypted traffic, behavioral IPS signatures are applied in real time across thousands of web-based and non-web applications.
- **DNS Optimization for Performance and Security:** Achieve faster resolution by pairing geographically local apps, driving better user experience and cloud app performance while implementing Domain Name System (DNS) security and control policies. With TLS/SSL inspection at scale, gain back visibility and stop attackers from abusing DNS-over-HTTPS (DoH), better protecting users and employees from reaching malicious domains and bypassing enterprise policies. By delivering DNS-as-a-service, Zscaler minimizes latency and secures local internet breakouts using full proxies for all DNS traffic and leverages machine learning to detect and block data exfiltration tunnel activity.
- **Easy-To-Understand Policy Management:** Universally define, deploy, and immediately enforce policies for all users, across all locations from a single console. In place of complex matrices of policy, network configurations and recreating policies for each location of typical firewalls, Zero Trust Firewall simplifies policy management by centralizing granular firewall rules based upon user, application, location, group, and department.
- **Enforce Precise Policies with Process-Level Awareness:** Extend Firewall, DNS, and IPS controls beyond IPs and ports by identifying the actual application process running on the device - such as PowerShell.exe or Chrome.exe. This enables security teams to block or allow activity based on the true source of the connection, reducing false positives, enhancing threat detection, and allowing more targeted risk response.



7.2.3.2 Zscaler Zero Trust Firewall Core Features:

FEATURE NAME	DESCRIPTION
Centralized policy management	Define and immediately enforce policies across all locations without the need to recreate policies for each location
Fully integrated security services	Share contextual information across DLP, APT, sandbox, and other services to provide better protection and deeper visibility
Real-time granular control, logging, and visibility	Maintain forensically rich logging for detailed visibility with globally unified and unlimited logging for six months, enabling analysis and correlation for trend discovery, productivity analysis, and troubleshooting
User-aware threat protection	Define users by Groups, Departments, or Locations, including setting work-from-home or remote users as a location, and integrate with identity providers and local user databases, allowing consistent policies regardless of users' physical locations
Endpoint App Control	Define and enforce policies based on the actual application process running on the device, such as PowerShell or Chrome, enabling more precise control, reducing false positives, and providing stronger protection against targeted threats and insider activity
App-aware threat protection	Supports a wide range of application types: • All network services - ports and protocols • Network applications identified by SNI (hostname) and Deep Packet Inspection (DPI) • Application Services such as UCaaS, using First Packet Identification, IP address, FQDN groups, and other heuristic-based detection methods
Advanced security inspection	Apply advanced deep-packet inspection on non-web protocols, including FTP, DNS, RDP, Telnet, and more to identify and prevent evasive traffic on non-standard ports
Adaptive IPS security with custom rules	Deliver always-on threat prevention with a cloud-delivered IPS engine powered by thousands of adaptive, behavioral, and context-aware signatures managed by Zscaler ThreatLabz. Gain additional control with Cloud Custom IPS, allowing you to define and enforce Snort-based rules tailored to specific applications, threats or compliance needs.
End user notifications (EUN)	Communicate security policy actions to end users through desktop pop-ups via Client Connector for Firewall, DNS, and IPS, or browser-based messages for DNS blocks with web EUN, helping users understand why access was denied and reducing IT support queries
	Create and assign custom admin roles—such as SecOps or

Granular role-based access control (RBAC)	NetOps—with controls over who can view, edit, or manage security policies, logs, and alerts to enhance operational clarity and enforce least-privileged access across teams
DNS security and control	Optimize cloud application performance and minimize latency while ensuring uncompromised security by proxying all DNS through Zscaler. Enable policies based on user, app, location, and resolved IP country to automatically block users from malicious domains and detect and prevent DNS tunneling • Resolution: DNS-as-a-service provides optimal resolution with localization, tenancy, and lowest latency • DNS Filtering: Create custom DNS filtering rules to block, allow, or redirect different types of DNS requests against known and malicious destinations • Security and Data Exfiltration: Detect malware, phishing, DNS tunneling, and data exfiltration using AI • DNS over HTTPS (DoH): Prevent DoH blind spots and bypassing of organizational controls when encrypting DNS connections in common HTTPS traffic
Fully qualified domain name (FQDN) policies	Easily configure and manage access policies for applications hosted across multiple IPs
File Transfer Protocol (FTP) control and Network Address Translation (NAT) support	Support access control of FTP and FTP over HTTP and support for NAT destination proxy and NAT forwarding
Globally shared protection	Leverage the cloud effect: every time a new threat is identified in any of the tens of billions of requests processed daily by the Zscaler cloud, it gets blocked for all Zscaler users, everywhere




7.2.3.3 Zscaler Zero Trust Firewall Licensing:

Zscaler provides two levels of license for our firewall, standard, and advanced.

Zscaler is proposing the advanced firewall license for **Higher Colleges of Technology (HCT)** to cover advanced firewalling requirements as well as DNS security requirements.

	Standard	Advanced
Zero Trust Firewall Policy Criteria		
Network and Application Services	 Up to 10 rules	
Source/Dest L3/4 and FQDN-based policies		
Location Awareness		
User Awareness	-	
Network Application (DPI)	-	
Dynamic Risk-Based Policy	-	
Geo-blocking (source & destination country)		
Firewall Rules	 Up to 10 rules	 Up to 10,000+ rules
Granular Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)		
End User Notifications (EUN)	 Web notifications for any DNS action	 ZCC notifications for any Firewall, DNS and IPS action
Endpoint App Control for process precision	-	
DNS Control		
Trusted DNS Resolver		

DNS Filtering and Security	✓ Up to 64 rules	✓
DNS Tunnel and App Detection	–	✓
Ips Control with Custom Rules	–	✓
Ftp Control	✓	✓
Nat Control	✓	✓
Platform Features		
Full SSL Inspection	✓	✓
Real-time Logging	✓ Aggregated logging details for allow firewall actions and detailed logging details for block actions with full DNS logs	✓ All logs for all actions and all functions including user ID, App ID, IPS, and more

7.2.4 Zscaler Zero Trust Sandboxing

Built on a cloud native, proxy-based architecture, Zscaler Cloud Sandbox is the world's first AI-driven inline malware prevention engine that blocks unknown, file-based threats before they reach endpoints. With real-time analysis, instant AI-driven verdicts, and continuous

threat intelligence sharing, our sandbox helps organizations stay ahead of sophisticated attacks without compromising productivity.

To cater to varying customer needs, the Zscaler Cloud Sandbox offers two options:

- Cloud Sandbox included with Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA), provides essential threat prevention capabilities for baseline protection.
- Advanced Cloud Sandbox delivers enhanced features such as AI Instant Verdict, granular policy control, API-driven analysis, and in-depth threat investigation for customers requiring more robust defenses.

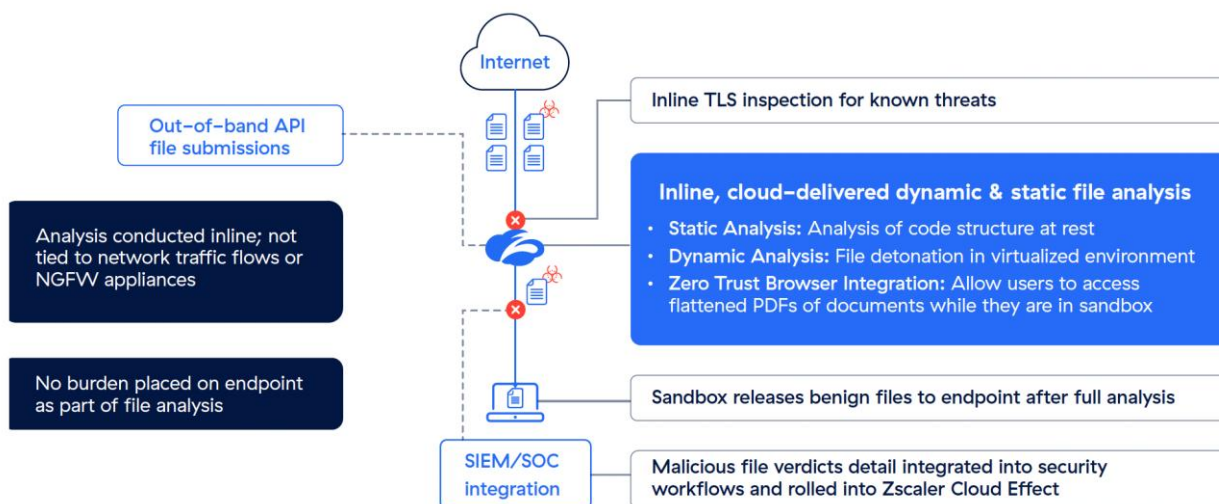
Unlike traditional sandbox solutions that depend on network firewalls or endpoint-heavy agents, Zscaler Cloud Sandbox operates directly from the cloud. It eliminates the burden on endpoints, requires no reliance on network traffic flows, and seamlessly integrates into SOC workflows for faster, more effective threat detection and response.

The sandbox operates in two key modes to ensure flexible and comprehensive security:



- **Inline Inspection:** Files are analyzed as traffic flows through the cloud, and AI delivers real-time verdicts to block threats without latency.
- **Out-of-Band Inspection:** Files can be submitted via APIs for a quick scan or in-depth analysis as needed.

By offering foundational and advanced options, Zscaler ensures that customers of all sizes can benefit from layered security tailored to their needs.



7.2.4.1 Zscaler Sandboxing Key Capabilities

- **AI-Powered Security:** Harness the power of AI/ML models trained on over 600 million samples to deliver instant, high-confidence verdicts on unknown files. The AI Instant Verdict engine predicts whether a file is malicious or benign in real time, allowing immediate blocking or rapid delivery to users without delay. For cases where files are flagged as “suspicious,” our customizable Minimum Threat Score enables users to fine-tune policy behavior, balancing security, and productivity. All confirmed threats are further validated through the Advanced Cloud Sandbox, which generates detailed reports and comprehensively analyzes the threat.
- **Layered Malware Detection:** Zscaler Cloud Sandbox delivers multilayered threat detection powered by real-time updates from over 500 trillion daily threat signals and the Zscaler Cloud Effect, which instantly blocks known threats for all customers once identified. The process begins with static analysis to inspect the file’s code structure while at rest, followed by dynamic analysis where the file is detonated in a virtualized environment to observe its behavior. A secondary static analysis examines any hidden or secondary payloads.

This layered approach, combined with inline protection and unlimited TLS/SSL inspection using our Single Scan, Multi-Action engine, ensures low-latency, high-performance threat prevention for even the most sophisticated, evolving threats

Signature



- Zero Trust Browser Integration:** The Zero Trust Browser integrates seamlessly with the Advanced Cloud Sandbox to ensure users remain productive without compromising security. This feature allows users to securely interact with original files in a cloud-based, isolated environment while the files undergo sandbox analysis. Risky or unknown files are automatically quarantined, but users can still access them securely during the analysis. If the sandbox analysis determines the file is safe, users can download the original version without delays.

If the file is flagged as malicious, users have options: they can download a flattened PDF version with all active content removed (CDR- 1) or, when appropriate, download an editable version with only the harmful content removed (CDR-3, may require additional licensing). This flexible integration ensures that users remain productive while zero-day threats are thoroughly examined and blocked when necessary. It is important to note that Zero Trust Browser is an optional module and works in tandem with the Advanced Cloud Sandbox to enhance the overall user experience.

- API-Driven Analysis:** Zscaler Cloud Sandbox's API integration streamlines investigations by allowing files to be sent directly to the sandbox for analysis. Security teams can easily access sandbox results via APIs, ingest them into SIEMs, SOAR platforms, or share with EDR solutions, enabling seamless SOC workflows. After detonation, the sandbox generates comprehensive reports, highlighting polymorphism, callback behaviors, and attack lifecycles, mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. These insights can be operationalized to enhance threat detection, response, and proactive threat hunting.

For flexibility, organizations can use the Advanced Sandbox Submission API for thorough analysis of files out-of-band supporting on demand submission and reporting of unknown threats, or the Deep Inspection Scan API to receive an instant verdict on a file sample. Both APIs help reduce investigation times and enhance collaboration across the security stack.

- Granular Policy Control and Reporting:** With Zscaler Cloud Sandbox, administrators can configure and enforce granular security policies tailored to specific user roles, locations, or application categories—all within just a few clicks. The intuitive interface allows for fast, simple policy creation and deployment, minimizing time and resource investment. Policies, including rule orders for precise execution, are easily managed and automatically follow users or groups, even when they change locations. For deeper control, admins can configure custom hash blocklists, YARA rules, and automated JA3 fingerprinting to enhance threat detection.

Signature

7.2.4.2 Zscaler Sandboxing Core Features

CAPABILITIES	DESCRIPTION
Prefiltering analysis engine	AV, file hash blocklists, YARA rules, automated JA3 fingerprinting detections, and ML/AI model
Static, dynamic, and secondary static analysis	All files go through 3 stages of sandbox analysis: static analysis, dynamic analysis, and secondary static analysis of all files dropped during dynamic analysis
File support	Check the following documentation for the list of supported file types: https://help.zscaler.com/zia/configuring-sandbox-policy
SSL inspection	Unlimited capacity
File retention	Zscaler Cloud Sandbox operates solely in memory. Files are stripped of identifiable information during analysis. After analysis is completed, benign files are purged from memory while malicious files are encrypted and stored indefinitely, sharing insights across all Zscaler's users for continuous protection (Cloud Effect).
Protocol support	HTTP, HTTPS, FTP, FTP over HTTP
Files per day	Unlimited capacity (inline)
Deployment method	Cloud native, no on-premises hardware or NGFW hooks needed
Threat intel integration	40+ security partner threat intel feeds
Management and reporting	Full reporting including malware behavior and intent, indicators of compromise (IOCs), dropped files, PCAPs
Forensics	Initial sample, secondary payloads, PCAPs
API support	Robust API support, two sample submission APIs and report retrieval via API in JSON format in summary or detailed formats
Granular policies	Easy to use and configure policies for users, location, location groups, file types, user groups, departments, URL categories, and protocols
3rd Party Independent Validation	AAA rating by CyberRatings

7.2.4.3 Zscaler Sandboxing Licensing

Zscaler is proposing the advanced sandboxing license for **Higher Colleges of Technology (HCT)**

FEATURE	VALUE	STANDARD CLOUD SANDBOX	ADVANCED CLOUD SANDBOX
File type support	Broad file- type coverage. Expand protection against evolving threats	 - Windows Executables - Windows Libraries - Zip archives	 Check the following documentation for the list of supported file types: https://help.zscaler.com/zia/configuring-sandbox-policy
AI Instant Verdict (AI/ML Quarantine and Blocking)	Allows benign or blocks malicious files in seconds with high confidence		 Available for select file types
Granular policies	Tailor security policies using multiple criteria-- users, locations, URL categories, and more	–	 Granular policies fitting many use cases can be created with ease
Reporting	Detailed reports with MITRE ATT&CK matrix mappings, TTPs, malware behavior and intent, IOCs, PCAPs, and more for actionable insights	–	 Multiple reports and dashboards are available, provides rich insights
API	Out-of-band API for on demand Sandbox file analysis	–	 Advanced Sandbox Submission API* (includes dynamic analysis) includes 3000 files per month by default Deep Inspection Scan API* (not including dynamic analysis) includes 5 files per day *Additional licensing may be required based on API usage requirements
Zero Trust Browser Integration	Automatically quarantine risky files allowing users to safely access the file during sandbox analysis	–	 Available for PDF and Microsoft Office files

7.2.5 Zscaler Zero Trust Browser (ZTBrowser)

Zero Trust Browser provides an organization the capability to isolate users from potentially harmful content on the internet. This is done by loading the accessed web page on a remote browser in any one of the many Zscaler data centers across the globe and streaming the rendered content as a stream of pixels to the user's native browser.

The overall solution of Zero Trust Browser consists of three primary components:

- A browser extension that handles web-based security and access
- A lightweight agent that enforces device posture controls and advanced data protection during the session
- And a cloud browser for accessing private applications in an isolated session.

Isolating web pages on an ephemeral, remote browser ensures that the HTML files, CSS files, JavaScript files, and any other active content served by the accessed web page never reach the user's machine or the corporate network, thus ensuring an air gap between the user and the web page they access.

Zero Trust Browser not only provides the capability to isolate web pages but also allows the user to view file types in isolation without requiring a download of the files to their local machine.

7.2.5.1 Zscaler Cloud Browser Key Capabilities

- **Secure Browsing:** Air-gapped browsing stops web threats to complement URL filtering, including AI-driven threat isolation stopping threats in any site that presents risk.

File isolation balances security and productivity, allowing users to interact with files in isolated sessions while preventing file-based threats from taking hold.

- **Secure Agentless Application Access:** Allow employees, contractors and third parties to safely access and use applications from any unmanaged device without the need for an agent. Allow employees, contractors and third parties to safely access and use applications from any unmanaged device without the need for an agent or VDI.

Fully isolate applications from users to eliminate the risk of vulnerable clients and malware-infected endpoints being leveraged by attackers to compromise applications.

- **Stops Data Leakage:** Allow secure access to web-based SaaS and private applications while restricting copy, paste, and print to prevent data leakage and theft. Get granular control of upload and download activity across SaaS and private applications to protect confidential business data from ending up on unmanaged endpoints.

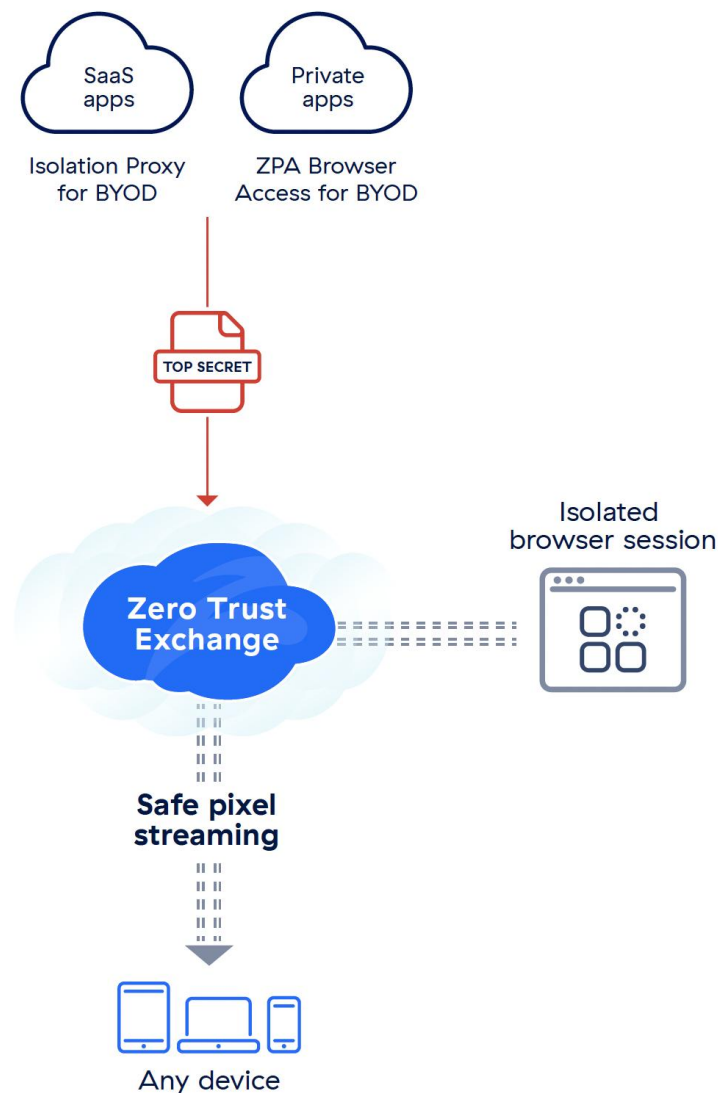
In addition to browser-based control, Zero Trust Browser enjoys full integration with Zscaler Data Protection portfolio to protect against sensitive data leakage.

7.2.5.2 How Zscaler Cloud Browser Works

For managed devices with Zscaler Client Connector, triggered policies for any app or web destination automatically isolate the session.

For unmanaged devices without ZCC, agentless access occurs via browser-based access in the Zero Trust Browser for both SaaS and web apps.





7.2.5.3 Zscaler Zero Trust Enterprise Browser (EB)

Zero Trust Enterprise Browser for Zero Trust Browser is for accessing private applications while in an isolated session. Traditional security technologies are not designed to focus on securing daily browser execution, and they often lack the needed layers of protection for all the complex operations that browsers perform. This feature enables organizations to detect, investigate, and control browser-native threats and sensitive data interactions in real time.

Enterprise Browser protects organizations without relying solely on traditional endpoint or network-centric controls. Instead, it combines several proactive methods: threat prevention, data encryption, and policy enforcement. It also utilizes tamper-resistant runtime on the browser for the entirety of a user's isolated session. Additionally, it continuously monitors malicious actions occurring inside browser sessions and fully analyzes user behavior as soon as the user starts interacting with web content.

The Enterprise Browser component prevents common attacks on users that occur in daily operations within browsers, such as:

- Accessing SaaS applications
- Uploading or downloading files
- Using browser extensions
- Interacting with generative AI (Gen AI) platforms
- Authenticating to cloud services



- Browsing internal and external websites
- Sharing sensitive information through collaboration tools

This feature is automatically a part of the Zscaler offerings for Zero Trust Browser, and admins do not have to manually enable it for users. When a user enters isolation, the isolated browser utilizes the Enterprise Browser capabilities and maintains the native look and feel of a regular browser.

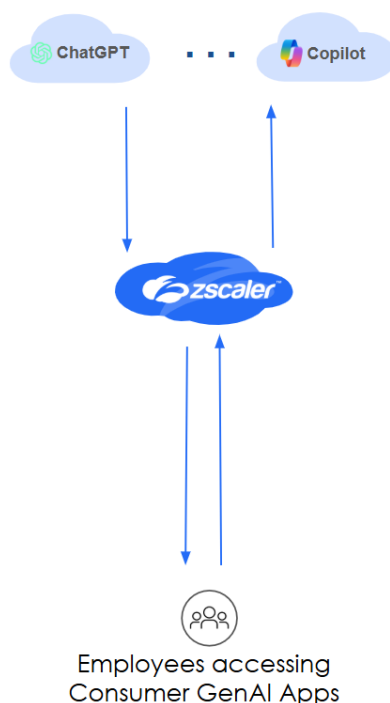
7.2.6 Zscaler AI Guard for Users

The rise of generative large language models (LLMs) has accelerated the pace of application innovation and increased productivity, with organizations customizing LLMs to their specific tasks. However, the proliferation of LLMs in apps and agents is creating new security challenges, including prompt injection, toxicity, and code leakage. This increasing adoption of LLMs necessitates the implementation of AI security in applications, in addition to cybersecurity and data security.

AI Guard is a service that provides run-time protection for your AI applications by enforcing enterprise policies that prevent prompt injections, block jailbreak attempts, and stop personal information leakage with guardrails around LLM interactions.

It secures these interactions by filtering harmful or inappropriate content from the prompts that users enter and the responses they receive in the AI application. AI Guard enforces intent-based detectors on both prompts and responses.

Secure Access to AI



7.2.6.1 Key Capabilities of AI Guard

The following functionality and guardrails are some of the options available to you with AI Guard:

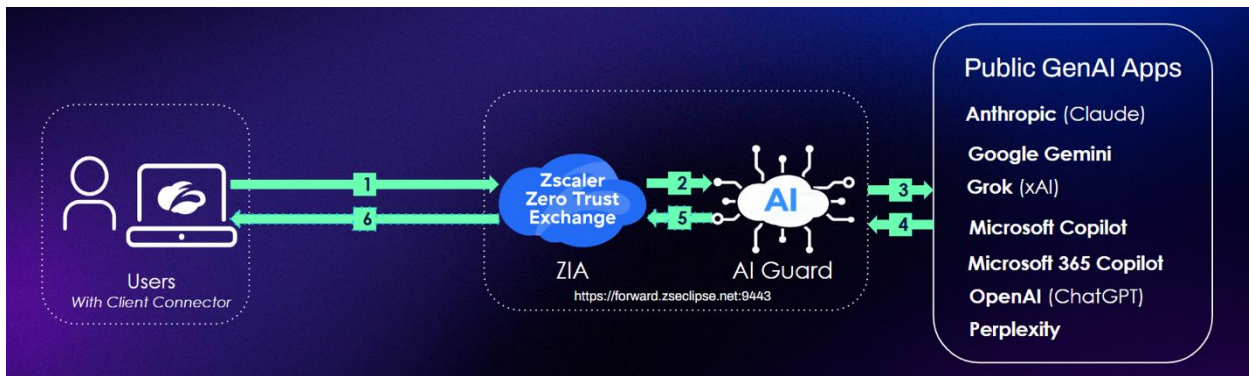
- **Visibility & Access Control:** You can monitor which applications are accessing private AI systems, with granular controls over access permissions. Visibility tools ensure complete oversight of private AI interactions across the enterprise.
- **Prompt Injection & Jailbreak Protection:** AI models can be manipulated with adversarial prompts to bypass restrictions or produce unintended outputs. The AI Guard guardrails detect and neutralize such attacks, ensuring that AI responses stay within defined safety parameters.
- **Toxicity:** AI-generated content can potentially be emotionally harmful for workers. AI Guard's guardrails apply real-time monitoring and filtering to prevent toxic language.
- **Sensitive Data Protection:** AI models can inadvertently expose or process confidential, regulated, or proprietary information. AI Guard enables inline inspection and classification to detect and block sensitive data before it is sent to AI APIs.
- **Off-Topic Response Detection:** AI Guard detects and prevents off-topic responses, ensuring that AI stays focused on its intended use cases.
- **Malicious URL Detection & Blocking:** AI-generated responses can sometimes include harmful or phishing links. AI Guard's solution actively scans links and blocks malicious URLs to prevent security threats and safeguard users from cyber risks.
- **Language Detection & Enforcement:** Organizations can enforce AI interactions in specific approved languages, preventing unauthorized language use that can lead to miscommunication or security vulnerabilities.
- **Code Injection & Execution Detection:** AI Guard detects and prevents unauthorized code snippets embedded in AI interactions, protecting against potential security risks from malicious scripts or unauthorized automation attempts.
- **Gibberish & Low-Quality Prompt/Response Filtering:** AI models can sometimes produce nonsensical or low-value responses. Our system detects gibberish, meaningless text, and irrelevant output, ensuring that AI responses remain coherent and valuable.
- **Refusal Detection & Intervention:** When AI refuses to respond to valid queries due to overly restrictive filters or misunderstanding, our system flags and intervenes to alert the security team because it might be a denial-of-service attack.
- **Finance Advice:** AI Guard can block actionable financial guidance (investing, trading, tax, product choices); allows neutral finance facts, history, and definitions.
- **Prompt Tagging-based Access Control:** AI Guard has prompt tagging model that automatically classifies prompts into different categories, enabling organizations to enforce AI governance, security, and compliance while optimizing AI interactions.
- **Competitor Discussion Detection:** You can identify and block prompts that reference competitors, rival products, pricing comparisons, or market strategies.
- **URL Reachability Detection:** AI-provided links can sometimes be outdated or unreachable. This guardrail verifies whether URLs in prompts are accessible, safe, or broken to prevent hallucinations.
- **Legal Advice:** Block prompts seeking legal advice, interpretation, or compliance guidance. This allows for neutral legal facts, definitions, and non-legal work inquiries.

7.2.6.2 AI Guard for Users Architecture

AI Guard for Users is a service that provides run-time protection for your generative AI (GenAI) applications on a per-user or user group basis by enforcing enterprise policies that prevent prompt injections, block jailbreak attempts, and stop personal information leakage with guardrails around LLM interactions.

It secures these interactions by filtering harmful or inappropriate content from the prompts that users enter and the responses they receive in the AI application. AI Guard enforces intent-based detectors on both prompts and responses.

The AI Guard for Users architecture includes the following key components:



1. Signing in to ZIA: Zscaler Client Connector authenticated users connect to ZIA in order to send traffic to it.
2. User prompt is analyzed by AI Guard: ZIA forwards traffic to the public GenAI apps using proxy chaining to the AI Guard infrastructure within Zscaler cloud (traditional Cloud App Controls, Web DLP, Threat Protection still occur here). If an AI Guard policy blocks the prompt, the traffic will not go to the GenAI apps.
3. Prompts that aren't blocked are sent to GenAI apps: If the prompt isn't blocked, AI Guard initiates (proxies) the traffic to the Gen AI apps.
4. GenAI apps response sent to AI Guard: The public GenAI apps return their response to AI Guard, where it is analyzed with policy response detectors if configured. If blocked, the user will instead receive a blocked message from AI Guard.
5. Response sent through ZIA: The response is sent back to ZIA.
6. User receives response: ZIA returns the response to the user.

7.3 Zscaler Private Access (ZPA)

The Zscaler Private Access (ZPA) service enables organizations to provide access to internal applications and services while ensuring the security of their networks. ZPA is an easier to deploy, more cost-effective, and more secure alternative to VPNs. Unlike VPNs, which require users to connect to your network to access your enterprise applications, ZPA allows you to give users policy-based secure access only to the internal apps they need to get their work done. With ZPA, application access does not require network access.

While ZPA is for connecting users to an enterprise's internal applications, Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA) is for connecting users to public applications on the internet.

Additionally, ZPA decouples applications from the physical network so you can provide seamless connectivity to private internal applications and assets whether they are in the cloud, the data center, or both. It also adjusts dynamically to network changes, so you can move your resources without impacting user access.

You can configure settings and policies on a central ZPA Admin Portal, which also feature dashboards where you can see your users and the apps they access, and monitor the health of your servers and resources. You can configure ZPA to automatically discover servers and applications when users request them, or you can configure them manually as well. You then define policies that specify which apps users or groups can use, and ZPA allows them to connect to those apps only. ZPA renders your applications invisible to all but the authorized users and unrouteable to anyone.

7.3.1 Key Capabilities

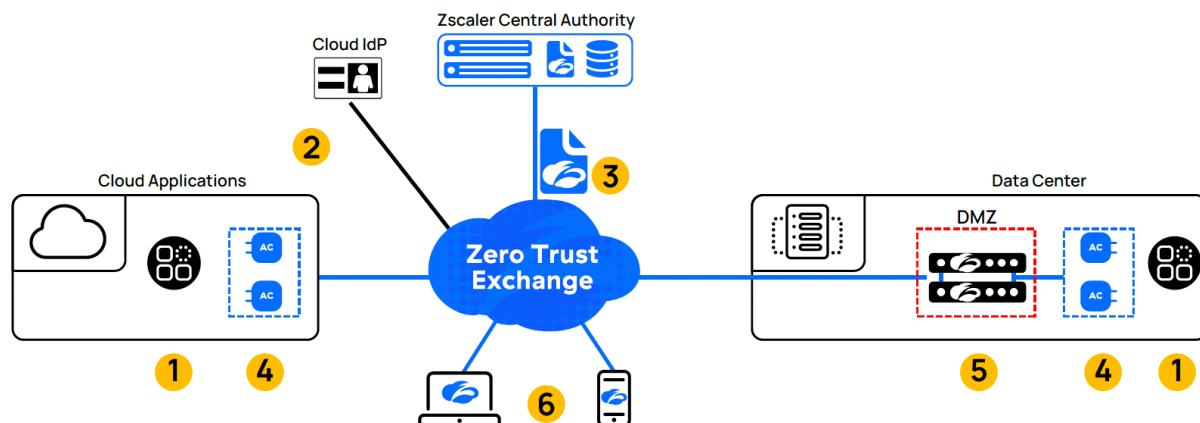
Below are ZPA key features and benefits:

- **Seamless User Experience:** Policy-driven connectivity that dynamically adjusts to network changes.
- **Enhanced Security:** Application-specific connectivity without ever bringing users on-net.
- **Ease of Deployment:** Does not require hardware or hardware upgrades.
- **Instant Deployment and Discovery:** Can automatically discover applications so you can easily build policies around them.
- **Single Sign-On (SSO):** ZPA is tied directly to your existing authentication infrastructure, leveraging SSO to further reduce complexity.
- **Real-Time Visibility:** Dashboards provide unparalleled visibility into your users and applications, and the health of your organization's applications and servers

7.3.2 Getting Started with ZPA

ZPA allows you to define a set of policies, authentication, and application definitions that combine to provide user access to applications. The ZPA service ensures that applications are available and that users have the correct policy applied.

The following ZPA components and configuration elements compose the foundation for implementing zero trust principles via user segmentation.



1. **Applications, Application Segments, and Segment Groups** – An application is a Fully Qualified Domain Name (FQDN), local domain name, or IP address that is defined on a standard set of ports. Applications must be defined within an application segment. Zscaler recommends using FQDN whenever possible. An application segment is a set of defined applications on shared ports across one or more back-end servers. A segment group is a set of application segments combined for policy purposes. Applications can be grouped into application segments and segment groups based on access type, authorized users, etc.
2. **SAML and SCIM Attributes** – SAML and SCIM attributes such as group membership, role, etc. are used in access policy rules to provide least-privilege access to applications. These attributes may originate in existing authentication/ authorization repositories, such as Active Directory, binding users

to relevant groups that reflect onboarding, movement to different departments, changes such as termination, etc.

3. **Access Policy** – Access policy rules enable context-based access control. To configure an access policy rule, you must first define which applications or segment groups the rule controls, and then define the context required for access. Additional context for access policies may include device posture, access type, network location, and other context provided by the SAML Identity Provider (IdP).
4. **App Connectors** – App Connectors provide a secure, encrypted, authenticated interface between a customer's servers and applications and the ZPA cloud for delivering user traffic to back-end applications.
5. **Private Service Edge** – A ZPA Private Service Edge is a single-tenant instance that provides complete broker functionality of a ZPA Public Service Edge in an organization's environment. For an on-premises user connecting via a local Private Service Edge and local App Connector, all control-plane and data-plane traffic stays within the network; the Private Service Edge communicates to the Zscaler cloud for management plane (configuration, logging, etc.) and delivery of user traffic to remote resources.
6. **Zscaler Client Connector** – Zscaler Client Connector is an agent that resides on your mobile or desktop devices. Supported on popular operating systems such as Windows, macOS, Android, iOS, and CentOS, this agent connects your devices to Zscaler's Zero Trust Exchange. At the ZPA Service Edge, requests are evaluated and approved users are connected to appropriate applications.

7.3.3 ZPA Cloud Architecture

ZPA was built from the ground up to provide secure remote access.

ZPA runs on a unique multi-tenant infrastructure, separate from that of Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA) solution, in order to make the service highly available. This separation ensures that when the same organization is using both services, public and internal traffic never mix on the same device. Additional measures are used to ensure security and privacy between organizations using the ZPA service, and in many cases, traversing the same equipment. Finally, all communication is encrypted end-to-end.

The ZPA service includes the following key components and subsystems:

7.3.3.1 ZPA Central Authority

The ZPA Central Authority (CA) is the "brain and nervous system" of the ZPA cloud. It is a geographically distributed system of in-sync nodes that are all actively servicing requests. To learn more, see ZPA Public Service Edges and the Central Authority.

The ZPA CA monitors the cloud and provides a central location for software and database updates, as well as policy and configuration settings. Each component of the system is aware of the health of the entire cloud, and policy is distributed across all components of the CA. It includes user interfaces connected via APIs to configuration components, as well as distributed dispatchers that track real-time application states.

7.3.3.2 ZPA Public Service Edges and ZPA Private Service Edges

ZPA Public Service Edges and ZPA Private Service Edges enforce user policies and provide secure transport to App Connectors. Maintained by Zscaler and deployed globally, ZPA Public Service Edges are the cloud-based portion of the ZPA data forwarding path, responsible for giving Zscaler Client Connector and App Connectors the ability to provide secure, authenticated, policy-based access to internal applications. ZPA

Private Service Edges act in the same capacity, but they are managed by an organization. The ZPA Public Service Edges and Private Service Edges are responsible for a variety of functions, including:

- Zscaler Client Connector and App Connector configuration and authentication, using public key cryptography.
- Creating and managing M-Tunnels, including authentication, policy, setup, teardown, and data forwarding. M-Tunnels are end-to-end encrypted connections designed to ensure that all traffic stays separate.

7.3.3.3 App Connectors

App Connectors provide the authenticated secure interface between an organization's application servers and the ZPA cloud. App Connectors can be distributed using lightweight virtual machines (VM) to run in legacy enterprise data centers and public cloud environments or as a package that can be installed under supported operating systems.

App Connectors are deployed in locations where internal applications reside, or they can be deployed in any location that has connectivity to those applications. ZPA selects the closest App Connector given the location of the user and the App Connector-to-application latency. It is best to install them in redundant (N+1) configurations, where (N) is the number of App Connectors required to support the applications, because they are always active. App Connectors never communicate with each other and do not accept inbound connections. They only require an outbound connection to the internet to reach ZPA Public Service Edges or Private Service Edges, so they can provide users access to internal applications in your organization.

Using a key pair (i.e., a provisioning key and a corresponding TLS client certificate), the App Connector and the ZPA cloud verify each other as part of enrolment. After an App Connector is enrolled, the TLS client certificate allows it to maintain its authentication with the nearest ZPA Public Service Edge or Private Service Edge, which provides the App Connector with its configuration and allows it to begin its operational tasks. These tasks include:

- Find applications as requested by users
- Act on behalf of the application to send traffic back to users
- Complete DNS requests on demand, based on established policies
- Monitor applications for their reachability

7.3.3.4 Logging Streaming Service

The Log Streaming Service (LSS) provides real-time and historical visibility into the operation of ZPA by analyzing events reported, primarily by the ZPA Public Service Edges or Private Service Edges. In addition to real time analytics and status, the LSS provides short and long-term storage.

Information sent to the LSS includes user activity and status, connector status, and http information related to Browser Access. The default fields in log templates created by ZPA do include personally identifiable information (PII). However, your organization can create a custom log template that only captures specific fields.

The LSS has two components: a log receiver and an App Connector. It can stream logs from your ZPA tenant to a SIEM or log receiver you manage. You must specify the logs required for streaming in the ZPA Admin Portal.

Because ZPA was purpose-built to ensure secure, private access to internal applications, the service does not store any information on any type of persistent media (i.e., disk) unless it is configured to do so by your organization. The information can also be obfuscated based on your organization's preferences.

7.3.4 Traffic Forwarding

There are two ways to manage traffic forwarding:



7.3.4.1 Zscaler Client Connector

Zscaler Client Connector is a client or app that is installed on a user's device (or endpoint), which authenticates the endpoint with the ZPA cloud and enables access to internal applications on behalf of that endpoint. Zscaler Client Connector verifies the integrity of both the ZPA infrastructure and the peers it is communicating with using public key cryptography.

Beyond the full authentication, as handled as part of the standard SAML 2.0 workflow, Zscaler Client Connector creates a unique fingerprint of the user's device. This means if someone copies Zscaler Client Connector from one device to another, the fingerprint generated by Zscaler Client Connector will prevent successful enrollment from the new device.

Zscaler Client Connector recognizes the internal applications that are available via ZPA. Access to these applications is defined in ZPA based on policies. Using information received from the ZPA Public Service Edge or ZPA Private Service Edge, it intercepts the user requests for those applications and then forwards those requests to the ZPA cloud. No network information is required to access available applications, and an organization can specify if resources must go through ZPA at all times, when on an untrusted network only, or never.

To facilitate secure private connections that are abstracted from the physical network, Zscaler Client Connector associates permitted internal applications with a set of synthetic IP addresses. So, when a client application (i.e., a web browser or SSH client) sends out a DNS request, Zscaler Client Connector is able to recognize the domain as an internal application being protected by ZPA. Zscaler Client Connector then intercepts the DNS request and delivers a DNS response to the client application that uses the synthetic IP address associated with the internal application.

Organizations can also use Zscaler Client Connector to direct user traffic to ZIA. Zscaler Client Connector identifies internal applications to forward traffic to ZPA, and other traffic goes to ZIA. If an organization is using ZIA and ZPA, Zscaler Client Connector will inherit some functionality from ZIA, including enrolment, user profiles, traffic management, etc. However, organizations do not need access to ZIA in order to use ZPA.

7.3.4.2 Browser Access

Browser Access allows you to leverage a web browser for user authentication and application access over ZPA. This allows users who cannot install the Zscaler Client Connector on their devices, but who still need access to applications, to do it over ZPA.

The application must be available via HTTP/HTTPS in a web browser that supports TLS 1.2. When a user tries to access an internal web application, they can open any web browser on their device and enter the application's URL. ZPA directs this traffic to the organization's identity provider (IdP), where the IdP authenticates the user and grants a SAML certificate before forwarding the traffic to a ZPA Public Service Edge or Private Service Edge. Browser Access is session based, so the user must authenticate via the IdP every time they access try to access the web application.

The ZPA Public Service Edge or Private Service Edge accepts the SAML certificate and applies all policies, making only permissioned internal web applications accessible to the user. If the policy allows the user access, ZPA identifies the best-path App Connector for the internal web application and connects them to it. When the ZPA Public Service Edge or Private Service Edge sends out a request to all App Connector sitting at the application level, the App Connector sitting closest to the internal web application responds by connecting to the ZPA Public Service Edge or Private Service Edge.

The connections from user to ZPA Public Service Edge (or Private Service Edge) and App Connector to ZPA Public Service Edge (or Private Service Edge) are then stitched together forming a TLS-encrypted tunnel, creating a secure channel between the authorized user and the internal web application without granting network access.

7.3.5 Understanding Communication Between Components and Subsystems

All communication between ZPA components travel within a mutually pinned, client and server certificate-verified, TLS connection. Within this TLS-encrypted Zscaler Tunnel, a microtunneling protocol exists. Select components of ZPA run through this encrypted Microtunnel end-to-end.

Because client and server use pinned certificates, it is cryptographically impossible for ZPA to experience a Man-in-the-Middle (MITM) attack. The client certificates are verified against an organization's Certificate Authority (CA), and the server certificates are verified against Zscaler's CA, which cannot be spoofed by any third-party compromised CA.

All Zscaler certificates are signed through an offline-only, air gapped, signing ceremony. ZPA only accepts connections from the Zscaler Client Connector and the App Connector instances that present a client certificate signed by a CA associated with each tenant. Zscaler Client Connector and App Connector will only connect to ZPA service components that present a certificate signed by the ZPA infrastructure PKI.

All certificates used within the ZPA infrastructure, including all organization-operated systems, have private keys that never leave the physical device in which they were generated. The private keys for each organization's Central Authority (CA) are stored in encrypted format (i.e., AES256-GCM). Proper best practices for public key lifecycles are always maintained.

7.3.5.1 Zscaler Tunnel

A Zscaler Tunnel (Z-Tunnel) is a TLS-encrypted, mutually authenticated point-to-point connection between Zscaler Client Connector and a ZPA Public Service Edge managed by Zscaler, or it's between an App Connector and a ZPA Private Service Edge managed by an organization. A Z-Tunnel does not contain any direct IP data. An additional Z-Tunnel is created between Zscaler Client Connector and a ZPA Public Service Edge, or between an App Connector and a ZPA Private Service Edge, to support multi-tenancy in Zscaler Client Connector. This allows Zscaler Client Connector to establish a Z-Tunnel with the tenant and establish a separate Z-Tunnel with the partner tenant. The second Z-Tunnel works without any additional setup or configuration. Also, the Z-Tunnel can carry multiple communication channels called Microtunnels.

Z-Tunnels are authenticated using public key cryptography. Zscaler Client Connector and App Connectors are authenticated with the organization's public key infrastructure (PKI). ZPA Public Service Edges and Private Service Edges are authenticated with Zscaler's PKI. In addition to the certificate-based authentication already applied, the Z-Tunnel is further authenticated using SAML 2.0.

7.3.5.2 Microtunnel

A Microtunnel (M-Tunnel) is an end-to-end communication channel created between Zscaler Client Connector and an internal application via a ZPA Public Service Edge or Private Service Edge and an App Connector upon demand.

An M-Tunnel originates at Zscaler Client Connector when traffic from a client application (i.e., a web browser or SSH client) attempts to connect to an application server, which is associated with a synthetic IP address. The M-Tunnel extends to the ZPA Public Service Edge or ZPA Private Service Edge using a tag created by Zscaler Client Connector. The M-Tunnel then extends to the appropriate App Connector using a different tag chosen by that connector. Finally, the App Connector connects the M-Tunnel to the actual application server providing the service originally requested by the client application.

At no point in the communication is actual IP identification data passed. Instead, the combination of tags created by Zscaler Client Connector and the App Connector function similarly to the label stack in a Multiprotocol Label Switching (MPLS) network. Just as in an MPLS network, where the label-switched path (LSP) uniquely identifies a connection, Zscaler Client Connector and App Connector tags identify a unique connection for each application request.

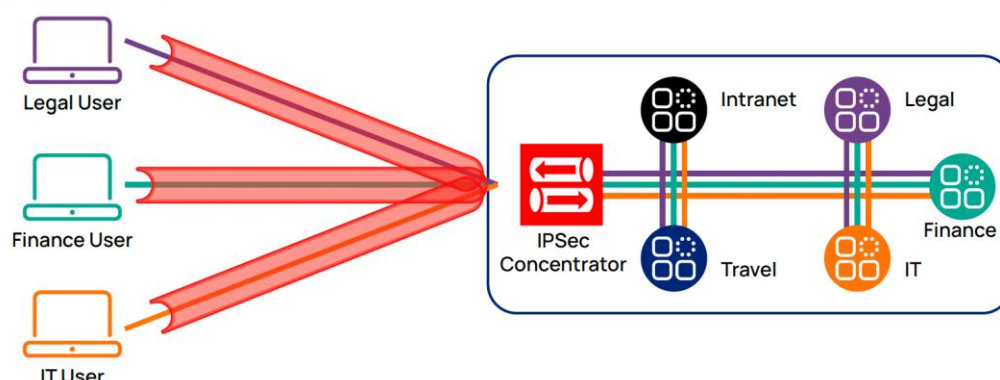


7.3.6 Transitioning to a Zero Trust ZPA Deployment

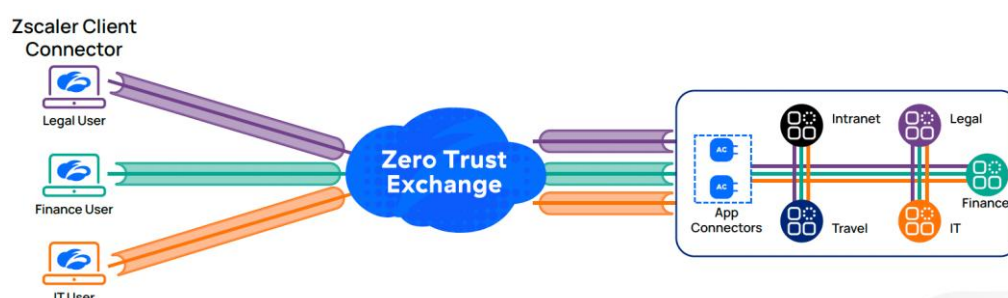
One common driver for ZPA deployment is to replace a remote access IPSec VPN. In the VPN model, endpoints are connected to a network, and access security must be handled by network segmentation or application controls. In your initial deployment of ZPA, you can do something similar with wildcard discovery. You can deploy ZPA in a policy configuration that mirrors the open-access VPN model with wildcard app segments and broad access policies. This allows you to make one conceptual change at a time: first change the transport to the applications, then work on granularity of control. This also reduces risk by ensuring that no user applications break due to policy restrictions.

At a high level, the starting point will look something like the following illustration, where users have access to various applications.

IPSec Clients



When transitioning to ZPA for access, it should be as transparent as possible to the end user. By setting up ZPA to use wildcard discovery, you are replicating the user's existing controls. After migration to Zscaler, initial setup will look something like the following illustration, mirroring your IPSec VPN access policy so users have a similar experience and access to the applications.



After your initial group is migrated to ZPA, you need to begin building more granular policy. The goal is to refine the app segment definitions, user context, and access policies based on what is learned in discovery, and to provide access to required applications only to users and user groups who should have access to these resources. This can be achieved in

Signature

multiple ways depending on the requirements. The same process of discovery and refinement allows you to extend your ZPA protection beyond the remote-access use case and also encompass on-premises user access.



How your organization progresses toward a zero-trust transformation will be defined by the kinds of access you want to grant and the relationship of the user, device, or location to your organization. Some use cases require using fully granular zero trust policies. Examples include third-party access to internal tools, or during an acquisition where the user

community is easily identified and the target resources are clearly scoped.

For other use cases, such as employee roles where the traditional approach has been full network access, a different approach may be required. A targeted access policy can allow only those users to get to a broad range of resources (e.g., *.internal.safemarch.com), enabling initial connectivity as well as dynamic application discovery. The resulting user activity logs offer visibility to inform development of more granular policies, so you can evolve towards more granular zero trust controls for those users as context becomes available.

It's important to remember that "success" at zero trust does not necessarily mean eliminating all wildcard access. There may be use cases in your organization where it's appropriate to provide a certain user community access to a full range of

applications within a certain domain or subdomain. Granularity then might mean ensuring that only authorized users on appropriate devices, possibly with additional context controls, are permitted access via that wildcard policy.

7.3.7 AI-Powered Segmentation

Zscaler's AI-powered Intelligent Application Segmentation is an advanced capability that streamlines the Zero Trust journey. It delivers precise user-to-Application Segmentation and tailored Access Policy recommendations, ensuring secure and efficient connectivity for users across the organization.

The AI/ML-powered Intelligent Application Segmentation is a ZPA feature built to assist the ZPA administrator with their journey towards Application Segmentation, providing Zero Trust access for private applications. It performs the following:

- Digests application access logs for the last 30 days
- Using the access patterns of the discovered applications, AI/ML provides recommendations for the following areas:
 - Identifies Application Segments required to serve the observed application requests, which would eventually help with removal of "open" (wildcard) Application Segments
 - Users and/or probable SCIM or SAML Departments/Groups that require the access which can be used in Access Policy definition

The outcome helps in reducing the attack surface (and henceforth limit lateral movement) by enabling the following:

- Application Segments defined with right set of FQDN/IP(s), port(s) and protocol(s)
- Least privilege access, so only the correct set of users have access to the correct set of applications via Access Policies

The AI-Powered Segmentation Automatically Discover and Group Unaccounted Apps

Application Segments | Browser Access | AppProtection | Privileged Remote Access | Segment Groups

Defined Application Segments | AI-Powered Recommendations | Application Segment Import

Name	Applications	Grouping Reasons	Attack Surface Reduction
20250903-4	prod_db_int01.acme.com prod_db_int102.acme.com + 5 Applications	PORTS AND PROTOCOLS SIMILARITY Consists of MySQL applications.	88.0%
20250903-8	hsk107632401.corp.acme.com 10.131.38.75 + 2 Applications	PORTS AND PROTOCOLS SIMILARITY Consists of RabbitMQ applications.	88.0%
20250903-10	jabslvc05421.acme.com	PORTS AND PROTOCOLS SIMILARITY Consists of Microsoft Endpoint Configuration Manager applications.	86.0%
20250903-13		PORTS AND PROTOCOLS SIMILARITY Consists of VMware applications.	87.5%
20250903-16		PORTS AND PROTOCOLS SIMILARITY Consists of Rockwell Automation applications.	87.0%

Automatically discovers and groups all inventoried and unaccounted apps

The AI-Powered Segmentation shows the exact risk reduction to each application group

Application Segments | Browser Access | AppProtection | Segment Groups

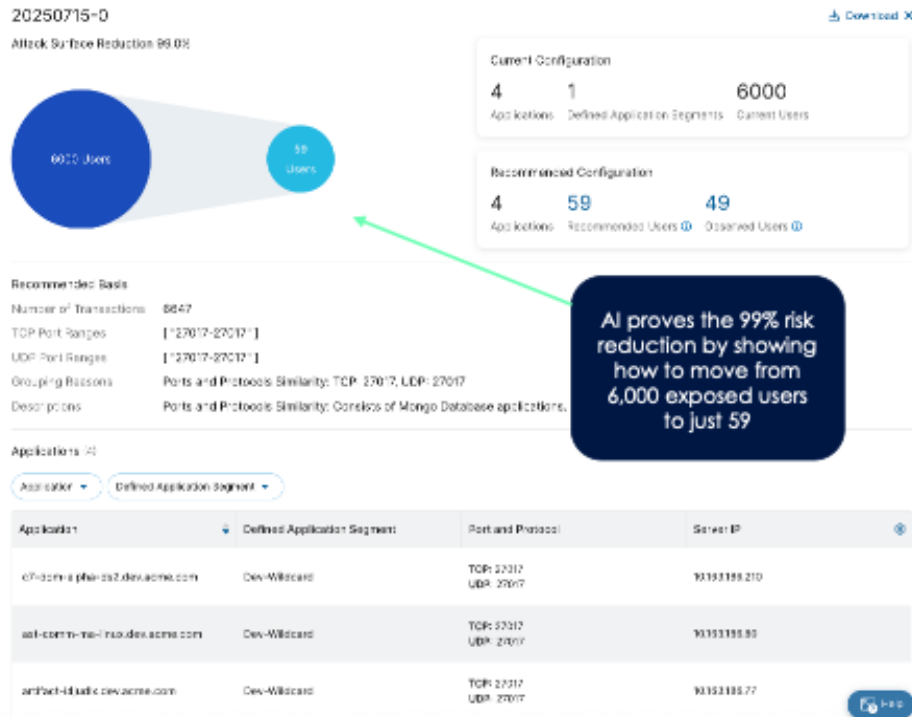
No filters have been applied

Name	Applications	Grouping Reasons	Attack Surface Reduction
20250903-4	prod_db_int01.acme.com prod_db_int102.acme.com + 6 Applications	PORTS AND PROTOCOLS SIMILARITY Consists of MySQL applications.	88.0%
20250903-8	hsk107632401.corp.acme.com hsk35.034476.corp.acme.com + 2 Applications	PORTS AND PROTOCOLS SIMILARITY Consists of RabbitMQ applications.	88.0%
20250903-10	jabslvc05421.acme.com	PORTS AND PROTOCOLS SIMILARITY Consists of Microsoft Endpoint Configuration Manager applications.	86.0%
20250903-13	nz_3c.ms.com nzuat_koc011-12.ms.com	PORTS AND PROTOCOLS SIMILARITY Consists of VMware applications.	87.5%
20250903-16	rk_n-89273L_int1027.acme.com	PORTS AND PROTOCOLS SIMILARITY Consists of Rockwell Automation applications.	87.0%

Shows the exact risk reduction for applying a policy to each application group

The AI-Powered Segmentation details the relevant users for each application and with one-click convert any AI recommendation into a secure application segment

Signature



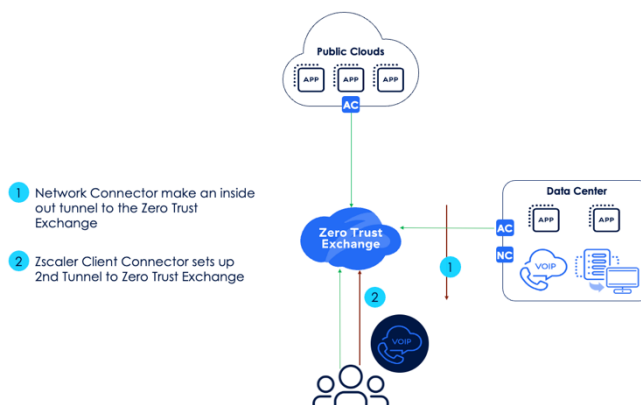
7.3.8 Zscaler VPN (For Legacy Apps)

The VPN service (for legacy apps) designed to manage exception traffic, specifically for VoIP and S2C applications, while facilitating the transition to a zero-trust network architecture.

This solution ensures continued access to applications that are not immediately adaptable to zero trust access, thereby minimizing disruption during the migration process to critical applications.

7.3.8.1 ZPA Architecture for VoIP and Server-to-Client Apps: Network Connectors, Secondary Tunnel, and Zero Trust Exchange

High-level solution design:



- Network Connectors (NC) can be deployed in datacenter/campus locations hosting VoIP servers and other server-to-client (S2C) systems. These connectors initiate an outbound connection to the ZTE, establishing a secure tunnel between the connector and the ZTE.
- Zscaler Client Connector (ZCC) builds a secondary tunnel specifically for users authorized for VPN services, also connecting to the ZTE. The ZCC is configured to forward traffic through this alternative path based on the configuration parameters set by the administrator.
- ZTE integrates the connection between the ZCC and the NC, creating an end-to-end encrypted pathway that facilitates secure communication for these applications.

7.4 Zscaler Digital Experience Monitoring (ZDX)

As your applications and work locations continue to evolve, so must your ability to monitor and diagnose application access and performance. Traditional monitoring tools for application performance and user experience relied on the ability to control and instrument the network and applications.

The rapid adoption of cloud and mobility initiatives within organizations and a shift to work-from- anywhere have introduced new monitoring challenges for IT teams. Applications are moving out of the data center and into the cloud.

They are being accessed by a hybrid remote workforce, meaning IT teams no longer control the underlying infrastructure and technology stack, and lose end-to-end visibility into the user experience. End user performance issues arising from SaaS or cloud application availability, home Wi-Fi issues, network path outages, or network congestion are not easily isolated and diagnosed.

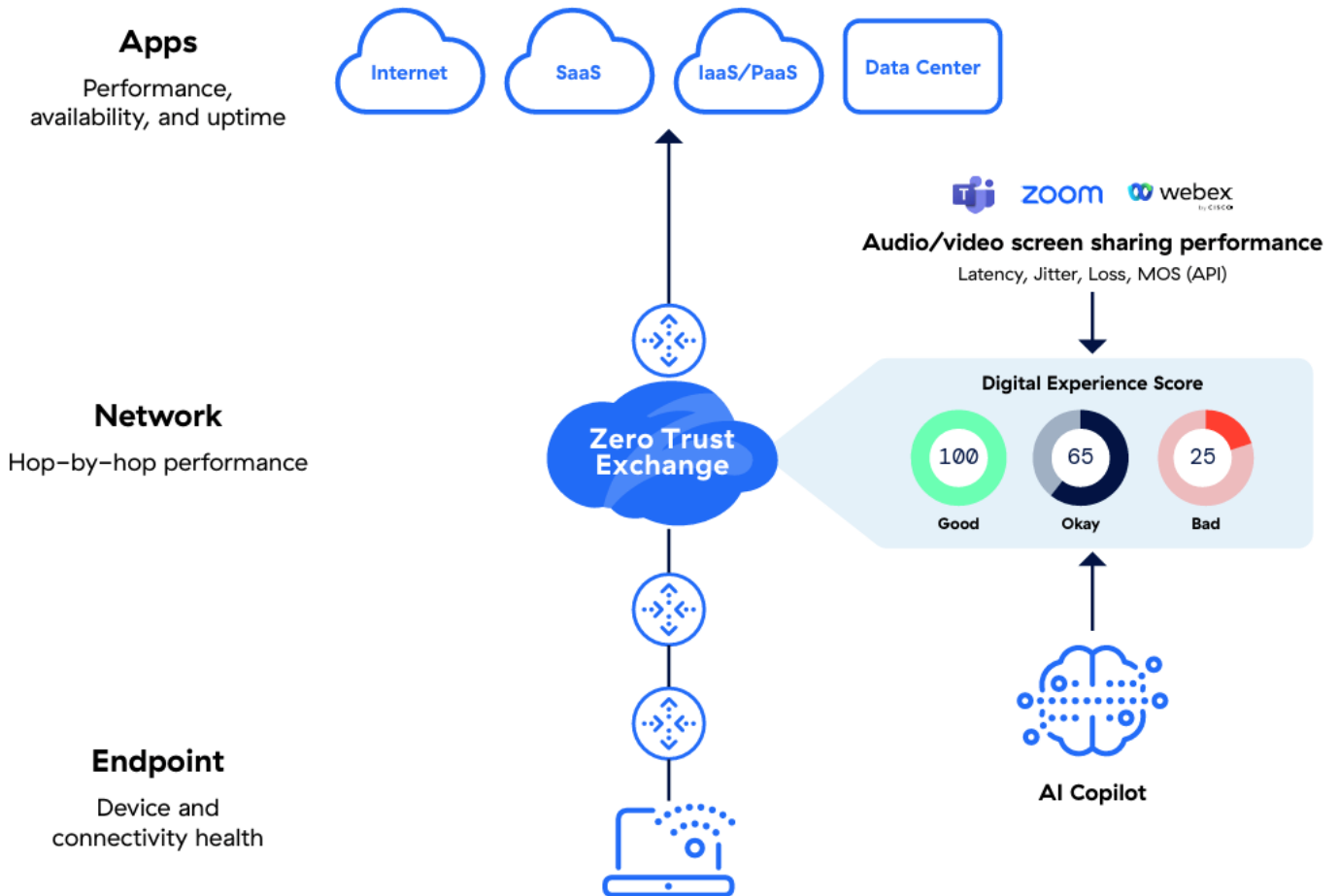
Digital experience monitoring for a hybrid workforce requires a modern and dynamic approach. IT teams need to continuously monitor and measure the digital experience for each user from the user perspective, regardless of their location. Traditional monitoring tools take a data center-centric approach to monitoring and collecting metrics from fixed sites rather than directly from the user device. This approach does not provide a unified view of performance based on a user device, network path, or application.

Zscaler Digital Experience (ZDX) is an AI-powered digital experience monitoring solution delivered as a service from the Zscaler cloud. ZDX provides end-to-end visibility and troubleshooting of end or customer performance issues for any user or application, regardless of location.

In addition, it enables continuous monitoring for network, security, and service desk teams with insight into the end user device, network, and application performance issues.

ZDX leverages Zscaler Client Connector and the Zscaler Zero Trust Exchange to actively monitor applications from an end user or customer perspective. It continuously collects and analyzes various performance metrics, including application availability, response times, network hop-by-hop performance metrics, and device health metrics such as device configuration, CPU, memory usage, process information, and device events. As a result, network operations and service desk teams get uninterrupted visibility and save time with proactive identification and resolution of end user experience and application or services issues.





7.4.1 Key Capabilities

ZDX lets you monitor granular details for users, devices, applications, and more in your org. With ZDX, you can:

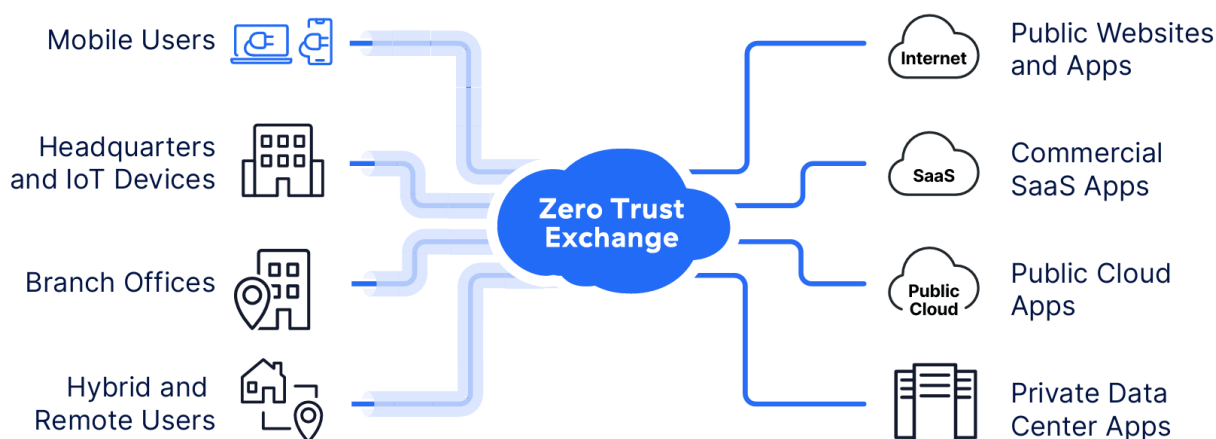
- Proactively monitor every user device in your organization to detect user experience and productivity issues.
- Grade your digital experience by referencing the ZDX Score over time for your organization and each application, location, department, and user.
- Triage performance issues and pinpoint whether the issue is in the local network, a user's device, the ISP provider, or within the Zscaler cloud.
- Use Zscaler's unified client, Zscaler Client Connector, to implement ZDX on Windows, macOS, Android, Android on ChromeOS, and iOS devices.
- Monitor general data center information and your key SaaS applications (i.e., Outlook Online, Salesforce, Box, etc.) using HTTP, ICMP, or UDP synthetic probes running on user devices in near real time.
- Collect real-time device health information (i.e., CPU usage, memory usage, Network IO, Disk IO, Wi-Fi signal strength, etc.) for your user devices.
- Hop-by-Hop network path visualization from the client device to the destination device.
- Threshold-based alerting for SLA monitoring.

Signature

- Remote troubleshooting capabilities to perform detailed analyses of problematic devices (i.e., system process-level monitoring, full network path information including the Autonomous System Number (ASN), ISP information, country hop information, and packet tracing).
- Executive insights reports and digital experience analytics aggregated at organization, location, and application levels.

7.4.2 Understanding ZDX Probes

For many years, traditional network monitoring tools existed with cloud applications by monitoring connections from fixed sites. Remote work was limited and often entailed a VPN connection to a central site for access to applications. The realities of newly remote and hybrid work have made that monitoring style of limited value.



ZDX instead monitors application availability from every user's device via Zscaler Client Connector. This is the same software that allows users to connect directly to applications using ZPA, or to a ZIA Public Service Edge for internet access. The ZDX feature of Zscaler Client Connector enables probes to be sent to configured web-based applications.

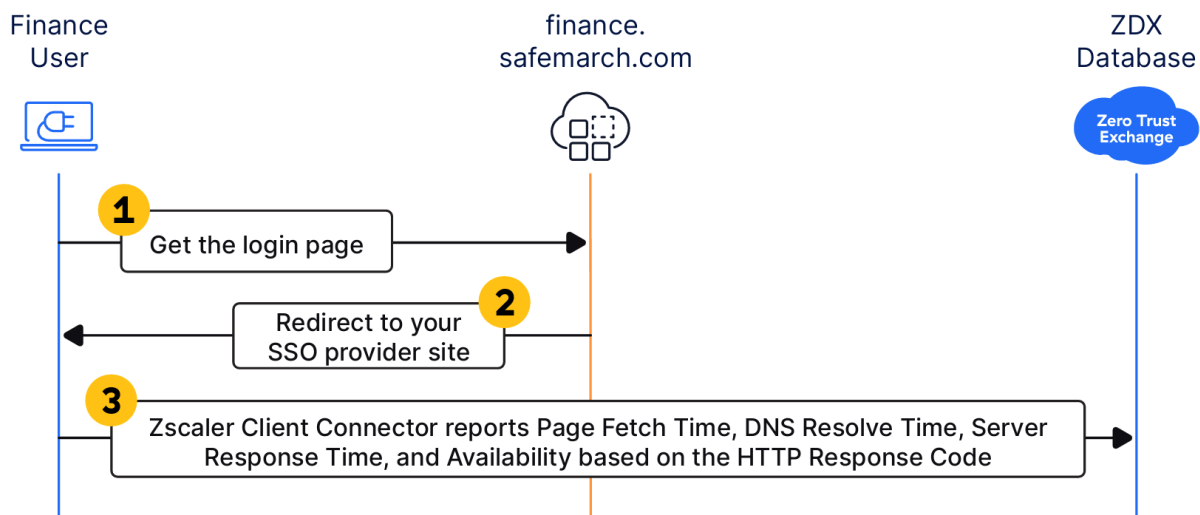
ZDX probes exist as part of an application you select. ZDX provides several preconfigured applications depending on your subscription level, and you can always define custom applications and probes. The probes check that your application is responding appropriately, and record latency and jitter statistics along the network path. These two functions are handled using two probe types:

- Web probes that check for application availability.
- Cloud Path probes that record hop-by-hop network performance information between the user and the application.

The data from these probes is combined with information about the user's device. This includes items such as CPU and memory usage, network usage, and Wi-Fi signal strength. This information is sent to the ZDX cloud. The data is aggregated and presented as a series of dashboards that allow you to see your organization's application performance. ZDX also supports configurable alerts, allowing your operations team to proactively address issues as they begin, not after they are reported.

7.4.2.1 ZDX Web Probes

The ZDX web probe makes an HTTP or HTTPS GET request to an application to check its service availability and responsiveness. When the application receives the request, it responds with an HTTP Status Code, such as a redirect to a login page. ZDX sends the probe and looks for the correct response code in return based on its configuration to mark the status as available or down.



- 1) A member of the finance team has Zscaler Client Connector installed. Zscaler Client Connector is configured to check that the finance application is running for anyone in the finance group. To do this, Zscaler Client Connector sends an HTTPS probe to the login page for finance.safemarch.com.
- 2) Finance.safemarch.com responds with a redirect to the organization's single sign-on (SSO) provider to authenticate.
- 3) The server response and the data around the response is sent to ZDX, which is configured to consider the redirect response as a sign that the service is operational.

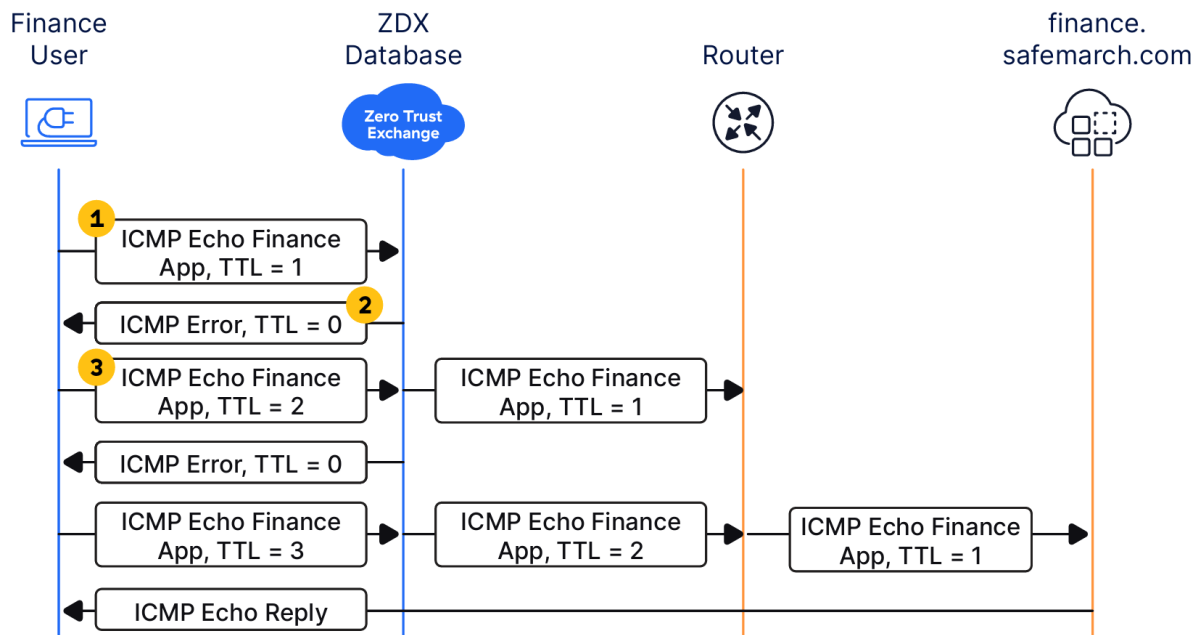
The ZDX web probes collect the following information about the application:

- **Page Fetch Time** – This metric collects the network fetch time of the web page from the URL-specified web probe. It requests only the top-level page document and does not request all embedded links within the web page.
- **DNS Resolve Time** – This metric represents the time it took to resolve the DNS name for the hostname specified in the web probe URL.
- **Server Response Time** – Time to First Byte (TTFB).
- **Availability based on the HTTP Response code** – If a success code is returned, the availability is either 1 or 0. If the probe times out, the availability defaults to 0.

7.4.2.2 ZDX Cloud Path Probes

Cloud Path probes work by sending packets with reduced time-to-live (TTL) values to map the path between the user-installed Zscaler Client Connector and the web application. Cloud Path probes can use ICMP, UDP,

or TCP, and can change these segment by segment. The system records the statistics as the probes come back or fail to come back.



- 1) The same finance user with Zscaler Client Connector installed, the agent begins sending probe packets out with a time to live (TTL) of 1, or 1 network hop away. The probes are sent 5 times with the same TTL.
- 2) At each hop, the router decrements the TTL by 1, dropping any probes that reach 0. Typically, a router sends a notification back to the sender that the TTL has expired, and that the packet has been dropped. Zscaler Client Connector records this data for each set of probes.
- 3) After the 5 sets of packets, Zscaler Client Connector increases the Cloud Path probe TTL by 1 and sends another series of 5 probes. This increase continues until the application is reached or the number of hops exceeds the systems limits.

Cloud Path probes are used to collect the following metrics:

- **Hop Count** – The number of hops between each hop point on the path.
- **Packet Loss** – The percentage of packet loss at each hop point on the path.
- **Latency (Average, Minimum, Maximum, and Standard Deviation)** – The roundtrip path time measured in milliseconds.

7.4.3 Applications Monitoring

Application definitions allow you to build web and Cloud Path probes to the application for monitoring. ZDX comes with a set of predefined applications as well as the ability to build custom applications. When using a predefined application, you enable the application and enter your tenant information for your organization. With a custom application, you need to build the web and Cloud Path probes to support that application.

Configuration

End User

20

Top Private Apps

Q Search

+ Add

Unified Communication ...

Predefined Apps Collect...

Custom Apps Collection

Predefined Apps Collection

Enabled

Total: 16

Probes: 8

8

Collection Details

View Details

Status

Q Search

Add Application

Application Name	Status	No. Probes	Last Updated	Actions
Box	Enabled	1 1	Jun 20, 2025 02:18 PM GMT+4	
Microsoft Login	Enabled	1 1	Jun 20, 2025 01:22 PM GMT+4	
Microsoft Teams Web App	Enabled	1 1	Jun 20, 2025 01:22 PM GMT+4	
Okta	Enabled	1 1	May 21, 2025 12:35 AM GMT+4	
OneDrive for Business	Disabled	1 1	Jun 20, 2025 02:13 PM GMT+4	
Outlook Online	Enabled	1 1	Jun 20, 2025 02:03 PM GMT+4	

7.4.3.1 Applications Definition

ZDX has predefined support for common large enterprise applications. Because these applications are already understood by ZDX, you only need to do minimal configuration before using them. The exact applications that are available to your organization depend on your ZDX subscription level. The following list includes all supported applications:

- Unified Communication
 - Microsoft Teams Call Quality
 - Webex Call Quality
 - Zoom Call Quality
- Web Applications
 - Box
 - Microsoft Login
 - Microsoft Teams Web App
 - Okta
 - OneDrive for Business
 - Outlook Online
 - Salesforce
 - Salesforce Classic
 - Salesforce Lightning
 - ServiceNow
 - SharePoint Online
 - Webex
 - Zoom




7.4.3.2 Defining Custom Applications and Probes for ZDX

Custom applications allow you to apply ZDX monitoring to applications that you run in your private data center or that are hosted in the cloud. These can be custom-built applications, privately hosted instances of applications, or cloud services.

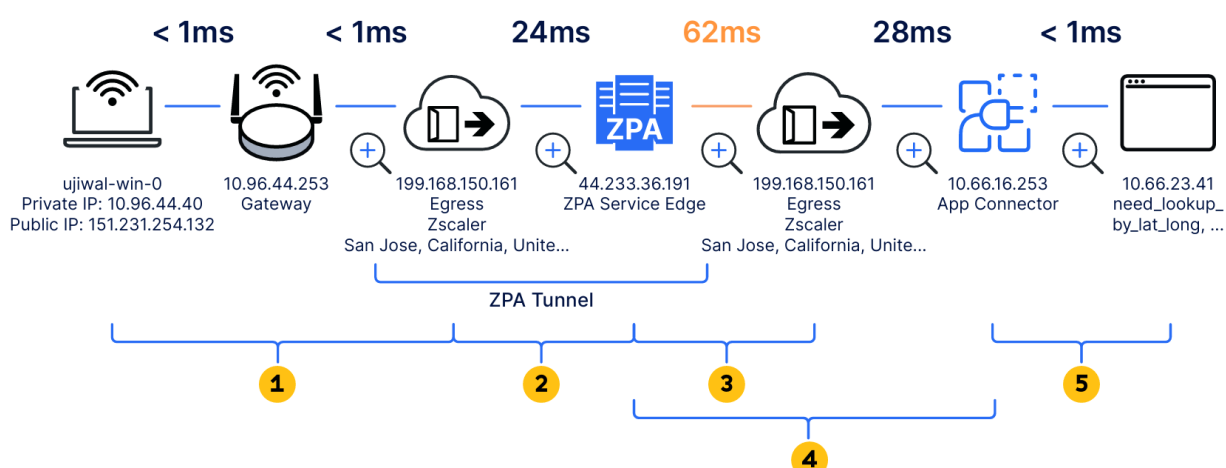
When you add a custom application, you must also add the associated probes to monitor the application. There are two types of probes you will build: a web probe and a Cloud Path probe. For each application, you will configure each probe type.

It is recommended that you build your web probes first, as the Cloud Path probe can follow the web probe and simplify configuration. Each probe has a frequency timer determining how often the probe should run.

7.4.4 ZDX, ZPA and Private Applications

ZPA offers the fastest, most secure access to private applications, services, and operational technology (OT) devices with the industry's only next-gen Zero Trust Network Access (ZTNA) platform.

ZPA allows you to make applications and OT devices invisible on the internet, reachable only through the ZPA service for authenticated and authorized users. When working with ZDX, ZPA allows you to leverage your existing authentication configuration and administrative accounts.



When you examine a user's path using ZDX with ZPA, there are 5 groupings of segments to consider as you begin your analysis:

- 1) **User Device to Egress Point** – This segment covers your user's device and the network gateway, up to the service provider edge.
- 2) **Egress Point to ZPA Public Service Edge** – This segment is the ISP network between your end user and the ZPA Public Service Edge.
- 3) **ZPA Public Service Edge to Application Egress Point** – This is the segment between the ZPA Public Service Edge and the egress point from the application's point of view.
- 4) **ZPA App Connector to ZPA Public Service Edge** – This segment contains segment 3, as well as the internal network between the ZPA App Connector and the ZPA Public Service Edge.
- 5) **ZPA App Connector to Application** – This segment is the internal network between the ZPA App Connector and the private application the user is trying to reach.

7.4.5 Device Scoring and Device Events

Without visibility into device events, IT support teams are forced into a reactive mode—waiting for users to report problems, which leads to increased downtime and user frustration. Device scoring evaluates **CPU, memory, disk, Wi-Fi, battery, and critical events like crashes**.

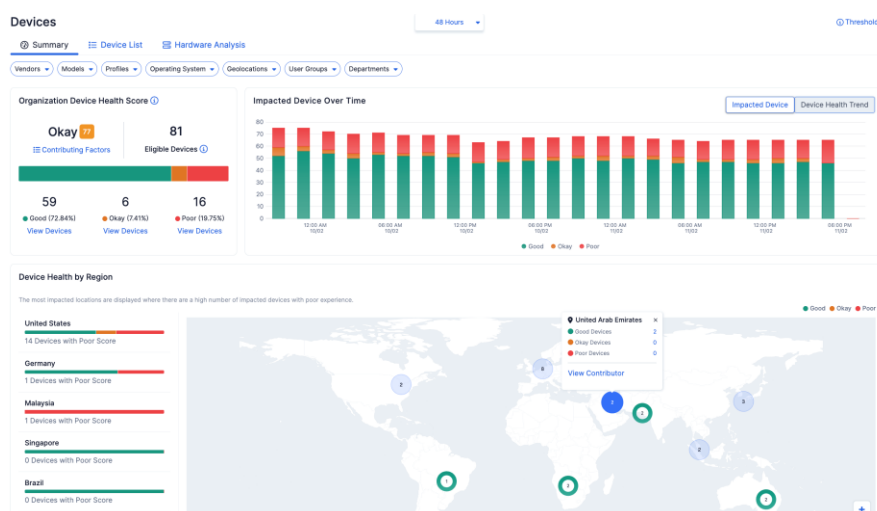
This approach not only delays issue resolution but also overwhelms service desks with preventable incidents. Adding to the challenge, critical device data is often spread across multiple external tools, creating silos and inefficiencies that slow down response times.

By implementing centralized device scoring and event tracking, organizations gain real-time insights into device health, enabling proactive support, faster root-cause analysis, and improved overall IT efficiency.

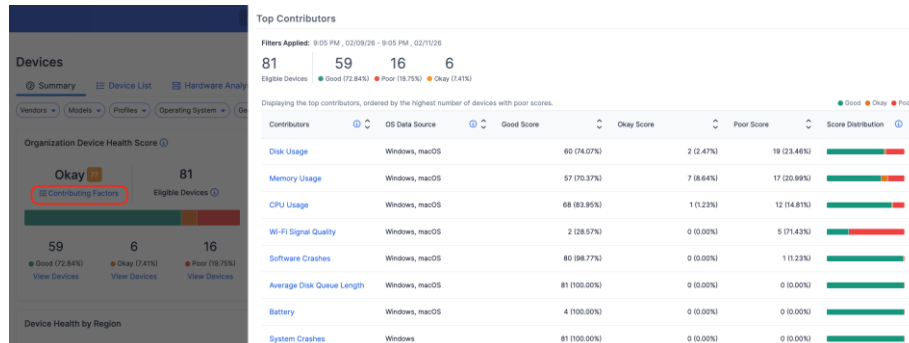
The Device Health dashboard uses existing user and device data to create a comprehensive device health scoreboard that monitors the performance of Windows and macOS devices. The dashboard provides useful data in evaluating trends to identify and understand the root causes of poor-performing devices. Then you can proactively collect device data and identify which devices require an IT's attention to remedy the device's poor performance (e.g., high CPU usage). With a dedicated dashboard, you can target hardware upgrades based on the device's usage for greater cost-effectiveness.

The ZDX's Device Health Score provides a comprehensive view of struggling devices across an entire organization, department, user group, or location. The score is determined by individual contributing metrics (e.g., CPU usage, memory usage, disk usage). The Device Health Scores are categorized as:

- **Good:** The usage profile has an acceptable Device Health Score and ranges from 66-100. The color for this range is green.
- **Okay:** The usage profile has an acceptable Device Health Score and ranges from 34-65. The color for this range is amber.
- **Poor:** The usage profile has a below an acceptable Device Health Score and ranges from 0-33. The color for this range is red.

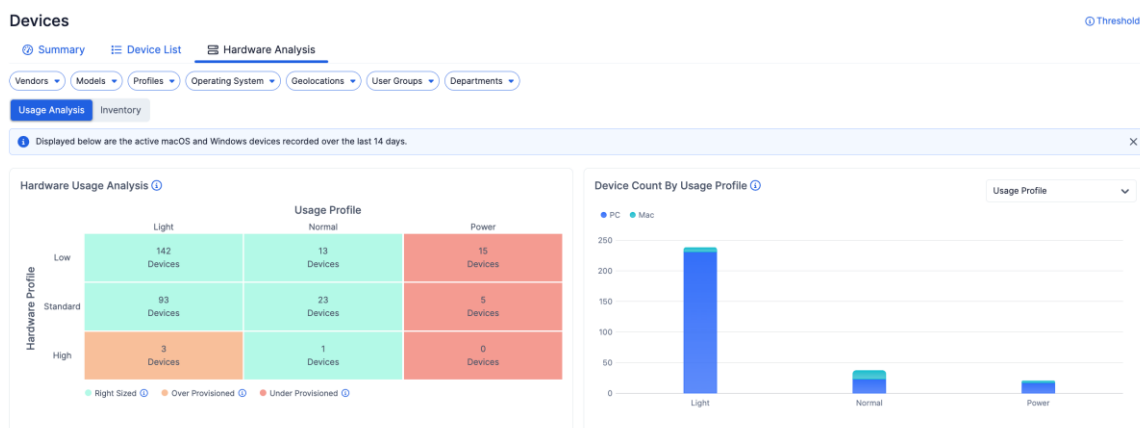


On the Summary page clicking on the **“Contributing Factors”** will view of what’s impacting device performance the most. It highlights key issues like high CPU usage, frequent crashes, or poor Wi-Fi signal in descending order of Poor score weightage.



The list of impacted devices can also be viewed by using the **“Device List”** option.

ZDX also offers a Hardware Usage Analysis displaying hardware profile based on hardware allocation and usage profile based on users and device usage trend.



8 Appendix B: Project Management

8.1 Project Management Methodology

8.1.1 Purpose

Help AG's Project Management Methodology targets the achievement of HCT's business objectives and needs by applying best practices. It also clarifies how risks, changes and any other factors that may have an impact on project scope, schedule and budget are managed, and how quality is maintained throughout the project lifecycle.

8.1.2 How Projects are Managed and Maintained

All Help AG's projects are supervised by an accomplished Project Management Office (PMO), managed by proficient Project Managers, and executed by highly skilled Subject Matter Experts.

- **Project Management Office (PMO)**

The PMO is equipped with up-to-date Project Management International standards, best practices and tools and is fully dedicated to monitoring and controlling project progress against requirements, deadlines, and quality standards, aiming to maximize project success rates and enhance client experience. It also acts as a successful escalation channel to take corrective and preventive actions whenever needed to ensure project success.

- **Project Managers**

Help AG PMs are fully equipped with project management skills and experience to capably satisfy client requirements within agreed-on scope, schedule and budget by: adhering to the defined project management methodology and standards, maintaining strong collaboration with our clients and efficient management of team members and other stakeholders including partners/vendors.

- **Projects Workflow Tool**

Help AG has developed a portal which is fully dedicated to enable proper reporting and in turn tracking of a project's status from its birth as a purchase order, until the achievement of all project deliverables and successful closure. It serves for effective reporting of changes, sharing major risks, and any other issues arising during the project lifecycle for immediate attention and action and maintains consistency throughout the organization. This transparent view into all projects enables more effective QA activities to take place to ensure projects are on track, and deliverables are developed according to plan, schedule, and quality standards.

8.1.3 Help AG's Project Management Methodology

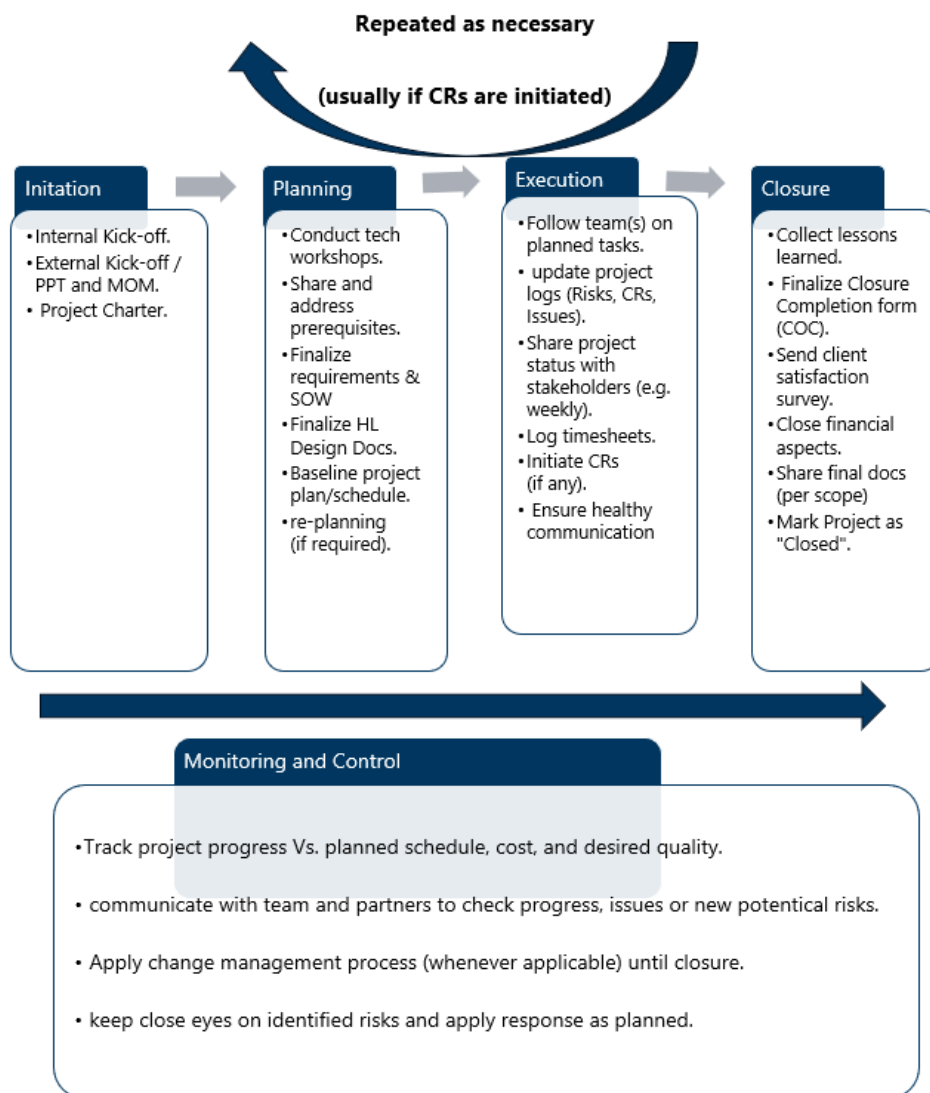
Help AG's project management methodology is aligned with international best practices and standards and has adopted PMI's (Project Management Institute) 5 main Project Management Process Groups Definitions, through which it manages its projects from initiation till closure.

Key success factors in delivering any project are having appropriate and well-defined procedures for planning, executing, monitoring & controlling, communication and reporting.

The five defined project phases/processes which define our project management lifecycle are **Initiation, Planning, Execution, Monitoring and Controlling and Closure**. Specific deliverables are stated as the physical outputs of each phase.

Please note that all deliverables will be developed using Help AG templates.





8.1.3.1 Initiation

During the initiation phase, a mutual agreement in the form of a Project Charter document between Help AG and HCT is drawn which clearly defines the project scope of work (SOW) in addition to other important project info such as deliverables, milestones and escalation matrix. An internal meeting is held by the PM and between the intended departments and members to confirm a general understanding of the project objectives and scope, and to document any questions/concerns and anticipated risks. A meeting with the HCT will then be conducted to share a common understanding of the project scope and client requirements. A MOM is written and shared with HCT stating the general output of the meeting.

The PM will then develop the Project Charter, including the Scope of Work, Product Description & Deliverables, Stakeholders Identification (if valid) along escalation matrix, Potential initial major Risks, Point of Contact and Client PM, Project Constraints, Pre-requisites and milestones. This is shared with the client to confirm an agreement on the content. A formal approval of the Project Charter is required for project continuation.

The following documents will be delivered at the conclusion of the initiation phase:

- Kick-Off Meeting PPT and MOM
- Project Charter



8.1.3.2 Planning

Planning allows the project manager to breakdown the high level intended deliverables into tasks, and to determine the skills, duration and dependencies required to deliver them. After the tasks are defined in the proper order for execution, each task is given a time frame, and assigned to an intended resource. A critical part of planning is anticipating potential risks, and ensuring they are kept on the radar for mitigating impact in case they occur.

The following documents will be delivered at the conclusion of the planning phase:

- **Baselined Project Plan/Project Schedule**
- **Prerequisites (whenever applicable)**
- **Final requirements and SOW (whenever applicable)**
- **HL Design Docs (if an already defined deliverable).**

Note: the **Planning** activities could be Repeated as per the project needs (usually if CRs are initiated).

8.1.3.3 Execution

During this phase, work to deliver the intended services/products is carried out under an umbrella of effective management of involved resources and team members according to the project plan. The project healthy communication and progress is monitored closely by the PM's and reported to the PMO periodically. Changes and potential risks are reported and tracked till closure. This phase includes:

- Delivering tasks based on agreed time, cost and quality parameters
- Identify, Reporting and managing potential changes and risks.
- Reporting progress to HCT weekly/biweekly

The following documents will be delivered at the conclusion of the execution phase:

- **Project Progress Report (including major Risks and Issues)**
- **MOM's / Emails**

Note: the **Execution** activities could be Repeated along with planning as per the project needs (usually if CRs are involved).

8.1.3.4 Closure

The objective of this phase is to draw a clear end to the project where HCT can confirm that the scope requirements & deliverables have been successfully met, and handovers to intended training, support and/or logistics teams are completed.

- Ensuring that all intended products/services have been accepted by HCT
- Planning and agreeing on any post project support or activities needed (not originally part of scope)
- Handing over intended arrangements to support and operations teams (if/when valid)
- Capturing and documenting lessons learned

The following documents will be delivered at the conclusion of the closure phase:

- **Closure Meeting MOM/email/report.**
- **Signed Certificate of Completion (COC form).**
- **Share final docs (per scope).**
- **Client Satisfaction Survey**

8.1.3.5 Monitoring and Controlling

This process continues from initiation till closure of the project. Project variables and deliverables are monitored against defined scope, quality standards, and time frame, through:

- Monitoring project progress against project plan; Updating plans with actuals.
- Conducting quality checks for project's adherence to standard procedures and for project deliverables
- Controlling and managing potential risks
- Controlling and managing changes and deviations and tracking them till closure
- Escalating intended and major issues/risks to PMO for immediate action if/when needed

The following documents will be delivered during and at the conclusion of this phase:

- **Updated Project Deliverables (if/when needed)**
- **Updated Project Plan/Schedule and logs (if/when needed)**
- **Change Requests (if/when needed)**

In conclusion, projects bring together resources, skills, technology, and ideas to deliver business benefits and to achieve business objectives; Help AG's project management methodology helps to ensure that these benefits and objectives are achieved within budget and to the required quality standards.

8.1.4 Applied Change Management Procedures

Help AG's change management procedures provide a basis to implement changes with minimal risk and impact on daily activities, and where project progress and efficiency is maintained. Following the procedures limits the possibility of unsuccessful changes and enables the Project Managers to respond faster to stakeholders demands, enhancing their experience. Changes follow the below process:

1. Define Configurable Items (items which go under Change Management Procedures) such as Project Schedule, Scope/SOW, Budget, design documents, etc.
2. Identify, analyze and Record requested Changes: notify decision makers of intended change for immediate action.
3. Raise Change Request with all relevant stakeholders (internal and external) if/when valid.
4. Once approved; Perform Needed Updates, where items are impacted by the desired change.
5. Baseline and confirm the implemented changed with Client.
6. Notify any Relevant Party of the Change
7. Track till Closure



8.1.5 Applied Risk Management Procedures

Proper risk management enables Help AG to succeed in the delivery of ambitious projects by defining their desired outcomes and then exercising procedures (as listed below) that maximize value and minimize uncertainty.



Benefits to abiding by the defined risk management process include:

1. It allows the team to manage risk effectively, concentrate resources on the things that really matter, resulting in risk reduction as the project proceeds, and assessment ensures risk impacted areas are managed properly.
2. It enables appropriate allocation of risk, so that the party best placed to manage it has the responsibility for doing so.
3. It provides a mechanism for reporting risk on a regular basis to the appropriate levels of management, escalating severe risks in an orderly manner to obtain direction from the highest levels.
4. It enables risk mitigation actions/responses to be pre-planned as risks are anticipated early in the project lifecycle, so if a risk arises, its impact is contained, tracked, and negative affect is minimized.

Sp Bt

8.1.6 Quality Assurance Procedures

Help AG has established a PMO office fully dedicated to the development and advancement of best practices in project management processes, guidelines, and metrics procedures. The PMO's primary responsibility is monitoring and controlling project progress against requirements, deadlines, and quality standards considering best practices.

Periodic spot checks are conducted to confirm project is progressing according to plan, and project deliverables are developed according to standards. The PMO ensures that all projects follow the defined project management methodology, and that proper change and risk management procedures are followed and tracked till closure.

Help AG's quality assurance procedures add value to our esteemed clients by:

- Maximizing efficiency and ensuring quality of service and deliverables
- Ensuring timeliness in requirement and scope satisfaction; within planned schedule and budget
- Ensuring issues, changes and risk subside with minimal or no impact on scope, schedule and quality.
- Ensuring the quality levels delivered are meeting the client expectations.

***Note:** The aforementioned is applicable when a dedicated PM is assigned to a project, in which case the PM services will be purchased. If a "dedicated PM" is not required, the technical consultant (Subject Matter Expert) will assume the PM role, and HCT will receive an initial Project Plan on an excel sheet at the start of the project, and will get weekly/bi-weekly progress reports (based on the agreement with the client) to update him/her on progress. A closure meeting will be conducted to close off the project, confirm scope completion, and get the Certificate of Completion signed.

Two revision cycles will be provided for each document. After the feedback from 2nd revision feedback is addressed, the document is considered formally approved and further adjustments will be considered out of scope and require a formal change request.



9 Appendix C: About Help AG

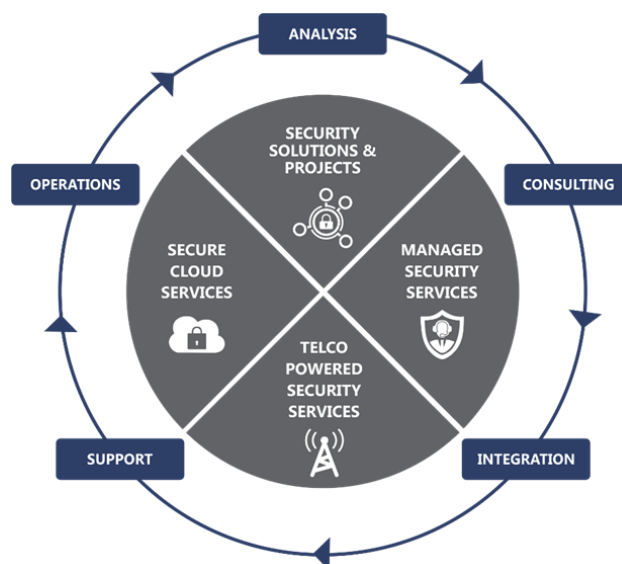
9.1 Our Mission

To contribute to securing a digital world through continuous innovation and thought leadership that elevate high profile organizations to greater levels of protection.

9.2 Help AG – Key Facts

- Founded 1995 in Germany
- Acquired by **e& group (formerly Etisalat Group)** in 2019
- 100% Shares owned by **e& group**
- Middle East HQ in Dubai since 2004 with additional offices in Abu Dhabi (2009), and Riyadh (2015)
- Over 500 customers in leading enterprises and Government across UAE and KSA
- 100% cybersecurity focused
- Highest number of information security technical consultants
- Highest level of vendor certifications
- Winner of multiple industry, vendor and government awards and recognitions
- Over 600 cybersecurity practitioners

9.3 Our Capabilities and Services Portfolio



9.4 Customer Satisfaction

Help AG is proudly customer focused and customer satisfaction is something we take very seriously. Our quarterly customer satisfaction surveys consistently show that 95% of respondents are satisfied with our response, professionalism, understanding of engineering problems and efficiency in solving issues. With Help AG, you are choosing a partner that will support you throughout your journey and ensure you are getting the best from your investments into cybersecurity programs.

By agreeing to this proposal, the Customer hereby acknowledges and agrees that Help AG is authorized to access, process, store, and transfer Data, including Personal Data, within Help AG group of companies, and this for the purposes of Help AG providing the Services, and ensuring support and related maintenance, as well as complying with applicable legal and contractual requirements, or other legitimate business needs of the Customer and Help AG group of companies. Help AG remains committed to implementing appropriate contractual, organizational, and technical safeguards to protect the Customer's Personal Data, pursuant to [Help AG's Privacy Policy](#).

9.5 Vendor Certificate



Letter Of Authorization

July 23, 2026

To: Whom so ever It May Concern

This letter shall confirm that **Help Information Technology Consultancy L.L.C.** ("Partner") is an authorized reseller of Zscaler, Inc. ("Zscaler"), with Partner Program Authorization level at **Direct-Premier**, products and services pursuant to a Reseller Agreement between Zscaler and Partner. As such, Partner can resell all Zscaler products and services.

Below are the appropriate Zscaler contact details should you have any questions or require additional information:

Mohammed Safi
+971508033820
msafi@zscaler.com

Sincerely,

DocuSigned by:

8981FED8E91467...

Steve Ndiritu
VP, Revenue Operations | Zscaler, Inc.

9.6 Major Vendor Partnership Levels

PREMIUM VENDORS	PARTNERSHIP LEVEL
Arista	Authorized Reseller
Attivo	Gold Partner
Aviatrix	Authorized Reseller
BeyondTrust	Gold Partner
Broadcom (Symantec)	Authorized Reseller (Select)
Carbon Black	Authorised Reseller
Check Point	2 Star Partner
Cisco Systems	Premier level, Advance Security Architecture Specialization
Cribl.io	Reseller
Crowdstrike	Reseller
Exabeam	Official Partner
F5 Networks	Platinum Unity+ Partner
FireEye	Gold Partner
Forcepoint	Platinum Partner
Forescout	Gold Partner
Fortinet	Expert
Gigamon	Reseller
Illumio	Authorized Reseller
Infoblox	Platinum Partner
Ixia	Elite Partner
Mandiant	Gold
Mimecast	Authorized Reseller
NetScout	Authorized Reseller with Partner Enabled Support (PES)
Netskope	Gold Partner
NOZOMI Networks	Accredited Partner
OPSWAT	Platinum
Palo Alto Networks	Diamond Innovator
Phishfort	Reseller
ProofPoint	Platinum Partner
Pulse Secure / Ivanti	Elite Partner
Semperis	Authorized Reseller
SentinelOne	Reseller
Skybox Security	Elite
Splunk	ELITE Partner
Tenable Network Security	Platinum Partner



Thales / Gemalto	Platinum Partner
Thycotic	Authorized Partner
TrendMicro	Platinum Partner
Vectra	Ambassador Partner
Zscaler	Authorized Reseller

9.7 Help AG Project Specific Customer References

CUSTOMER NAME	PROJECT TITLE
AD Ports Group	Zscaler ZPA Licenses via Etisalat
ADAFSA (Abu Dhabi Agriculture and Food Safety Authority)	Zscaler licenses via Etisalat
ADMM (Abu Dhabi Motorsports Management)	Zscaler SASE Solution via Etisalat
ADNOC (Abu Dhabi National Oil Company)	Zscaler Solution with Cisco Servers via Etisalat
ADQ (ADDH-Abu Dhabi Development Holding P.J.S.C.)	Zscaler Solution
AWQAF (General Authority of Islamic Affairs and Endowments -GAIAE)	Zscaler licenses
CDA (Community Development Authority)	Zscaler NSS licenses
COP28	Zscaler,Proofpoint,PAN & MSS via Etisalat
DANS (Dubai Air Navigation Systems)	Zscaler Licenses via Etisalat
DDA (Digital Department of Ajman)	TrendMicro,LogRhythm,Zscaler & MSS Services
DED Abu Dhabi (Department of Economic Development - Abu Dhabi)	Palo Alto Renewal and Zscaler Licenses
DEWA (Dubai Electricity and Water Authority)	Zscaler Web Security via Etisalat
DFSA (Dubai Financial Services Authority)	Zscaler SASE
DIEZ (Dubai Integrated Economic Zones) (Merge DSOA & DAFZA)	Zscaler Subscription via Etisalat
DIFC (Dubai International Financial Centre)	Zscaler licenses
DSOA (Dubai Silicon Oasis Authority)	Zscaler Business Edition Subscription via Etisalat
Dubai Airports	Zscaler Licenses Via Etisalat
Dubai Courts	Zscaler Add-On Subscription via Etisalat
Dubai Investments	Zscaler Renewal and Upgrade via Etisalat
EK (Emirates Group)	Zscaler Renewal + Additional License via Etisalat
MORO HUB	Zscaler via Etisalat



Mubadala	Zscaler
RAK Ports	Zscaler 3Yr Subscription
Wasl (Asset Management Group)	Zscaler Private Access Solution via Etisalat

9.8 General Customer Reference

Our customers are enterprise organizations with the most complex security requirements.

Aviation	Banking	Defense	Education	Government	Oil & Gas	Miscellaneous
      	             	             	       	             	      	             

Signature



9.9 Help AG Certificates



Certificate of Registration

INFORMATION SECURITY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM - ISO/IEC 27001:2022

This is to certify that:

Help Information Technology Consultancy
Sole Proprietorship L.L.C
The Galleries Building 3
12th Floor, Downtown Jebel Ali
Dubai
United Arab Emirates

Holds Certificate No:

IS 651103

and operates an Information Security Management System which complies with the requirements of ISO/IEC 27001:2022 for the following scope:

Provisioning of an Information Security Management System (ISMS) that applies to all its information assets, systems, services and premises, supporting the security of information processed, transacted, and stored within the organisation, as well as the operation of its business processes, in accordance with the Statement of Applicability (SOA) V1.2 dated 07 April 2025.

For and on behalf of BSI:

Theuns Kotze, Managing Director Assurance - IMETA

Original Registration Date: 2016-06-15

Effective Date: 2025-06-15

Latest Revision Date: 2025-05-13

Expiry Date: 2028-06-14

Page: 1 of 2



...making excellence a habit.™

This certificate was issued electronically and remains the property of BSI and is bound by the conditions of contract.
An electronic certificate can be authenticated [online](https://www.bsigroup.com/ClientDirectory).
Printed copies can be validated at www.bsigroup.com/ClientDirectory

Information and Contact: BSI, Kitemark Court, Davy Avenue, Knowlhill, Milton Keynes MK5 8PP. Tel: +44 345 080 9000
BSI Assurance UK Limited, registered in England under number 7805321 at 389 Chiswick High Road, London W4 4AL, UK.
A Member of the BSI Group of Companies.





Certificate of Registration

BUSINESS CONTINUITY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM - ISO 22301:2019

This is to certify that:

Help Information Technology Consultancy
Sole Proprietorship L.L.C
The Galleries Building 3
12th Floor, Downtown Jebel Ali
Dubai
United Arab Emirates

Holds Certificate No:

BCMS 781490

and operates a Business Continuity Management System which complies with the requirements of ISO 22301:2019 for the following scope:

The provisioning of a Business Continuity Management System (BCMS) that covers all assets, systems and services to support the continuity of its business functions and the delivery of services.

For and on behalf of BSI:

Matt Page, Senior Vice President, EMEA Assurance

Original Registration Date: 2023-02-09

Latest Revision Date: 2025-11-11

Effective Date: 2026-02-09

Expiry Date: 2029-02-08

Page: 1 of 2



...making excellence a habit.™

This certificate was issued electronically and remains the property of BSI and is bound by the conditions of contract.
An electronic certificate can be authenticated [online](https://www.bsigroup.com/ClientDirectory).
Printed copies can be validated at www.bsigroup.com/ClientDirectory

Information and Contacts BSI, Kitemark Court, Davy Avenue, Knowlhill, Milton Keynes MK5 8PR. Tel: + 44 345 080 9000
BSI Assurance UK Limited, registered in England under number 7805321 at Seventh and Eighth Floors, The Acre, 90 Long Acre, London, WC2E 9RA, UK.
A Member of the BSI Group of Companies.

This document or email (including any attachments) contains CONFIDENTIAL information intended solely for the use of the individual or entity to whom it is addressed. If you have received this communication in error, please notify the sender immediately and delete the email. Unauthorized use, disclosure, or distribution of this information is strictly prohibited.





Certificate of Registration

IT SERVICE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM - ISO/IEC 20000-1:2018

This is to certify that:

Help Information Technology Consultancy
The Galleries Building 3
12th Floor, Downtown Jebel Ali
Dubai
United Arab Emirates

Holds Certificate No:

ITMS 794337

and operates an IT Service Management System which complies with the requirements of ISO/IEC 20000-1:2018 for the following scope:

Includes the Information Technology (IT) Operations department of Help AG, with planning, managing, delivering, and improving all IT services based in Dubai's Head Office, and supporting internal customers at its Branches and Offices in the Middle East in line with the IT Service Catalogue (LG-ITSM-001) 11 Oct 23.

For and on behalf of BSI:

Theuns Kotze, Managing Director Assurance - IMETA

Original Registration Date: 2024-02-05

Effective Date: 2024-02-05

Latest Revision Date: 2024-02-05

Expiry Date: 2027-02-04

Page: 1 of 1



...making excellence a habit.™

This certificate was issued electronically and remains the property of BSI and is bound by the conditions of contract.
An electronic certificate can be authenticated [online](#).
Printed copies can be validated at www.bsigroup.com/ClientDirectory.

Information and Contact: BSI, Kitemark Court, Davy Avenue, Knowlhill, Milton Keynes MK5 8PP. Tel: + 44 345 080 9000
BSI Assurance UK Limited, registered in England under number 7805321 at 389 Chiswick High Road, London W4 4AL, UK.
A Member of the BSI Group of Companies.





Letter of Recognition

ISO/IEC 27035-2:2023 - Information technology — Information security incident management

The Letter of Recognition is granted to:

Help Information Technology Consultancy
e& Al Kifaf Building, 13th Floor
Sheikh Khalifa Bin Zayed Road
Dubai
United Arab Emirates

Hold this Letter of Recognition No: SPLIC 825711

The Organization has demonstrated that they have followed the guidelines provided for ISO/IEC 27035-2:2023 in their organization for the following Business activity:

The incident response and best practices for information security incident management within Help AG's Managed Security Services business unit. Includes security technologies, systems, services, processes, information assets, information processing facilities, and people involved in managing and operating Help AG's Managed Security Services. The Incident management services support sites located in The United Arab Emirates and The Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.

Signed on behalf of BSI

Theuns Kotze - Managing Director, IMETA

Last Audit Date: 18.04.2025

BSI Management Systems
Suite 03, 13th Floor
Al Niyadi Building
Airport Road
PO Box 129835
Abu Dhabi - UAE

T: +971 2 443 9660
bsi.me@bsigroup.com
bsigroup.ae

The British Standards Institution
Incorporated by Royal Charter
Principal office: 389 Chiswick High Road London, W4 4AL, United Kingdom
Companies House number: ZC000202

Ap Bt

